

Eigenvalues of Tetrahedral sums of Hermitian matrices

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Abstract

Horn's problem is concerned with characterizing the eigenvalues (α, β, γ) of a triple of Hermitian matrices (A, B, C) satisfying the constraint $A + B = C$. The development of a complete solution to Horn's problem, due in large part to breakthroughs by A. Klyachko, A. Knutson, and T. Tao, has led to deep connections between eigenvalues of Hermitian matrices, tensor product invariants of matrix groups & Littlewood-Richardson coefficients, geometric invariant theory and the intersection theory of Schubert varieties via cohomology.

Here, we define and investigate a generalization of Horn's problem which we refer to as the *tetrahedral Horn's problem*. The tetrahedral Horn's problem is concerned with characterizing the eigenvalues $(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi)$ of a sextuple of Hermitian matrices (A, B, C, D, E, F) satisfying the constraints $A + B = C$, $B + D = F$, $D + C = E$ and $A + F = E$. In this paper, we describe the scaling, shifting and tetrahedral symmetries of the tetrahedral Horn's problem, as well as conjecture the existence of additional symmetries generalizing the Regge symmetries present in the case of 2×2 Hermitian matrices. Furthermore, unlike the solution to Horn's problem, we show that the space of admissible sextuples of eigenvalues is neither convex nor a polytope. We demonstrate this qualitative difference by solving the tetrahedral Horn's problem for 2×2 matrices explicitly.

For the general case of $d \times d$ Hermitian matrices, we collect a handful of previously known matrix inequalities for sums of positive semidefinite Hermitian matrices and reinterpret them as necessary conditions for the tetrahedral Horn's problem. For a complete characterization, we provide a direct proof, using spectrum estimation techniques from quantum information theory, that the admissibility of a given sextuple of eigenvalues is encoded in the semiclassical asymptotics of the norm of the generalized Wigner $6j$ operator for the unitary group $U(d)$. Our result generalizes the well-known correspondence between admissible eigenvalues for Horn's problem and Littlewood-Richardson coefficients, and partially generalizes the well-known semiclassical analysis of J. Roberts for the case of $d = 2$.

Moreover, we provide a new elementary proof of an upper bound on the Hilbert-Schmidt norms of $6j$ operators using the Cauchy-Schwarz inequality. Combining this upper bound with estimates coming from the large $d \rightarrow \infty$ asymptotic limit, we obtain a new proof of a previously known submodular inequality involving unnormalized entropies of sums of positive semidefinite matrices.

Finally, we show how it is possible to embed positive semidefinite Hermitian matrices and their sums into multipartite density matrices such that further generalizations of the tetrahedral Horn's problem can be viewed as a special case of the spectral quantum marginals problem. From this perspective, we obtain an alternative new proof of the aforementioned submodular unnormalized entropy inequality. Motivated by this connection to multipartite quantum states, we consider the set of possible allocations of unnormalized entropies of sums of positive semidefinite matrices and prove it forms a convex cone. This convex cone, which we call the additive quantum entropy cone, serves as an analogue of Pippenger's quantum entropy cone; indeed we prove that every balanced inequality that is valid for the quantum entropy cone is also valid for additive quantum entropy cone, thus extending an open conjecture of J. Cadney, N. Linden, and A. Winter.

TC: This is the main document for the project "TETRASPECTRA".
Previous drafts are located in the folder titled "old" and will not necessarily compile properly.

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1 Introduction

There are a number of operations involving the transformation of Hermitian matrices under which it is possible to track the effect had of the corresponding sets of eigenvalues. For example, the eigenvalues, $\text{eig}(X)$, of a Hermitian matrix, X , are invariant under conjugation by unitary matrices, $\text{eig}(X) = \text{eig}(UXU^\dagger)$, covariant under taking positive powers $\text{eig}(X^p) = \text{eig}(X)^p$, covariant under multiplication by real numbers, $\text{eig}(rX) = r \text{eig}(X)$, and covariant under the addition of scalar matrices, $\text{eig}(X + rI) = \text{eig}(X) + (r, \dots, r)$. The operation of adding together Hermitian matrices is not an operation of this type. Specifically, the eigenvalues $\gamma = \text{eig}(A + B)$ of the sum of two matrices cannot be determined from the eigenvalues $\alpha = \text{eig}(A)$ and $\beta = \text{eig}(B)$ of the summands *alone*. Stated differently, to determine the eigenvalues involved, additional

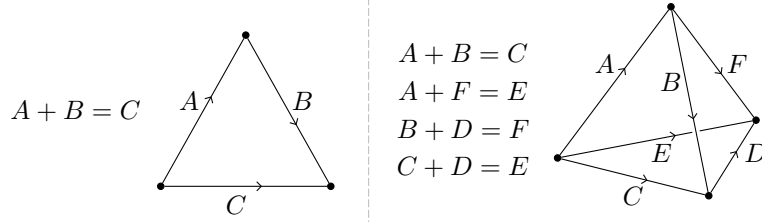


Figure 1: (Left) The *triangular* Horn's problem subjects three Hermitian matrices, (A, B, C) , to the constraint $A + B = C$ forming a triangle in the vector space of Hermitian matrices. (Right) The *tetrahedral* Horn's problem subjects six Hermitian matrices, (A, B, C, D, E, F) , to a quadruple of constraints forming a tetrahedron in the vector space of Hermitian matrices. [fig:tetrahedron_labelling_scheme](#)

knowledge about the eigenvectors involved is typically required. Nevertheless, there are numerous mathematical situations wherein knowledge about the eigenvectors involved is lacking, yet it remains desirable to determine the set of admissible eigenvalues of a sum given the eigenvalues of the summands.

The problem of determining the set (α, β, γ) of admissible eigenvalues has been investigated for over a century yet has come to be known as *Horn's problem* after Horn who, in 1962, conjectured a solution to the problem in the form of an inductively defined, finite set of homogeneous linear inequalities. These inequalities, now known as the *Horn inequalities* describe a polytope of admissible values for (α, β, γ) [Hor62]. In 1998, Klyachko provided a solution to Horn's problem [Kly98] which, when combined with a proof of the so-called saturation conjecture, due to Knutson and Tao [KT99], constitutes a proof of Horn's original conjecture [Ful98].

For applications of Horn's problem to quantum information theory and Nielsen's theorem [Nie99], see the article due to Daftuar and Hayden [DH05].

In parallel to Horn's problem, numerous variations and extensions of Horn's problem have been explored by various authors. For example, numerous authors have considered the admissible eigenvalues of unitary matrices and their product [AW97; Bel08; BK16], or the admissible singular values of matrices and their product [Spe05; TT71]. In 2000, it was shown by [Kly00] that *logarithms* of the admissible singular values of non-singular matrices and their product are identical to the admissible eigenvalues of Hermitian matrices and their sum, thus proving a conjecture due to Thompson [Kly00]. This correspondence between the singular values of a product and the eigenvalues of sum has been generalized substantially by Alekseev, Meinrenken, and Woodward [AMW01]. For a pedagogical and historical introduction to Horn's problem, we recommend the review articles of Bhatia [Bha01], Knutson [Knu00], and Fulton [Ful00].

Recent developments surrounding Horn's problem not covered by the aforementioned reviews include the development of the geometric method by Sherman [She15] and Berline, Vergne, and Walter [BVW18] originally pioneered by the geometric proofs due to Belkale [Bel02; Bel05], as well the characterization and computation of the induced distribution over the eigenvalues of the sum given random matrices with fixed spectra in a series of papers by Coquereaux and Zuber [CZ18; CZ18; CMZ19; Zub18].

In this paper, we consider a generalization of Horn's problem previously considered only briefly in a paper due to Christandl, Şahinoğlu, and Walter [CŞW18]. While Horn's problem aims to characterize the eigenvalues (α, β, γ) of a triple of $d \times d$ Hermitian matrices (A, B, C) which are subjected to the constraint $A + B = C$, the generalization consider here aims to characterize the eigenvalues $(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi)$ of a *sextuple* of $d \times d$ matrices (A, B, C, D, E, F) subject to four constraints: $A + B = C$, $B + D = F$, $D + C = E$ and $A + F = E$. These constraints arise naturally from building a kind of tetrahedral arrangement of Hermitian matrices inside the vector space of Hermitian matrices according to Fig. 1. Consequently, throughout the paper, we refer to this generalization of Horn's problem as the *tetrahedral Horn's problem* and, by contrast, Horn's original problem, involving the sum of just two Hermitian matrices, as the *triangular Horn's problem*.

Beyond the superficial connection between the imposed constraints and the resulting shape formed in the vector space of Hermitian matrices (as in Fig. 1), in the special case of 2×2 Hermitian matrices, this connection is much deeper. It is well-known that the space of admissible eigenvalues for a triangular

arrangement of 2×2 traceless¹ Hermitian matrices is in correspondence with the moduli space of Euclidean *triangles* in $\mathbb{R}^3$ [HK96; FKL10; Knu00]. As we shall see in Section 2.3, this correspondence generalizes in the sense that the admissible eigenvalues for a tetrahedral arrangements of 2×2 traceless Hermitian matrices is in correspondence with the moduli space of Euclidean *tetrahedra* in $\mathbb{R}^3$. While this latter result is straightforward to prove and also well-known, indeed it forms the basis of the semiclassical asymptotics of the $SU(2)$ Wigner $6j$ symbols [Rob99], it leads to a complete solution to the tetrahedral Horn's problem for 2×2 matrices. In Section 2.3, we will see that the moduli space of Euclidean tetrahedra in $\mathbb{R}^3$ is provided by the positivity of so-called Cayley-Menger determinant [SJS18].

Although we are ultimately interested in tackling the tetrahedral Horn's problem for $d \times d$ Hermitian matrices with $d > 2$, the $d = 2$ case already demonstrates a strong qualitative difference between the triangular and tetrahedral variants of Horn's problem. In particular, while the triangular Horn's problem is completely characterized by a *finite* number of *linear* inequalities in the eigenvalues (indeed the solution space is an instance of a moment polytope known as *Horn's polytope*), the solution space for the tetrahedral Horn's problem is in general *not a polytope*.

TODO: Finish the introduction

- Talk about connections between Horn's problem & Schubert calculus
- talk about semiclassical asymptotics of $6j$ symbols
- talk about entropy cones and open problems regarding entropy cones
- talk about known submodular inequalities for PSD matrices
- describe the scope & results of the paper (more detailed abstract)
- describe structure of the paper

¹One can always assume, without loss of generality, that the Hermitian matrices involved are traceless due to a simple shifting symmetry which is described in Section 2.2.

2 Tetrahedra of Hermitian matrices

2.1 Definitions

`prob:tet_problem`

Problem 1 (Tetrahedral eigenvalues). A sextuple $(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi) \in (\mathbb{R}_{\text{dec}}^d)^{\times 6}$ of candidate eigenvalues are said to be *tetrahedral* if there exists a corresponding sextuple (A, B, C, D, E, F) of $d \times d$ Hermitian matrices satisfying (i) the four linear constraints

$$A + B = C, \quad B + D = F, \quad C + D = E, \quad A + F = E, \quad (1)$$

`{eq:tet_linear_constraints}`

and (ii) the six eigenvalue constraints

$$\text{eig}(A) = \alpha, \quad \text{eig}(B) = \beta, \quad \text{eig}(C) = \gamma, \quad \text{eig}(D) = \delta, \quad \text{eig}(E) = \epsilon, \quad \text{eig}(F) = \phi. \quad (2)$$

`exam:one_dim_soln`

Example 2 (Tetrahedral Horn's problem for $d = 1$). Perhaps the simplest example of the tetrahedral Horn's problem occurs when $d = 1$; i.e., when Hermitian matrices and their eigenvalues are identified with real numbers. In this case, the tetrahedral Horn's problem reduces to the problem of which sextuples of real numbers (a, b, c, d, e, f) simultaneously satisfy

$$a + b = c, \quad b + d = f, \quad d + c = e, \quad a + f = e, \quad (3)$$

`{eq:one_dim_tet_conds}`

or equivalently, are such that $(a, b, c, d, e, f) \in \ker \Gamma$ where Γ is the 4×6 matrix of coefficients appearing in Eq. (3):

$$\Gamma := \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 & -1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 & 0 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 & -1 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 & -1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}. \quad (4)$$

It can be shown that the above coefficient matrix has a three dimensional kernel and, in particular, one can parameterize the solution space by $(x, y, z) \in \mathbb{R}^3$ according to the formula

$$(a, b, c, d, e, f) = (x, y, x + y, z, x + y + z, y + z). \quad (5)$$

`{eq:one_dim_soln}`

Remark 3 (Traces are tetrahedral). In the original, trigonal version of Horn's problem, the eigenvalues (α, β, γ) of Hermitian matrices (A, B, C) satisfying $A + B = C$ necessarily must satisfy a basic equality condition known as the *trace condition*:

$$|\alpha| + |\beta| = |\gamma|, \quad (6)$$

`{eq:tri_trace_cond}`

where $|\lambda| := \sum_i \lambda_i$ is shorthand for the sum of the eigenvalues $\lambda = (\lambda_1 \geq \dots \geq \lambda_d)$. This condition must hold because $A + B = C$ implies $\text{Tr}(C) = \text{Tr}(A + B) = \text{Tr}(A) + \text{Tr}(B)$ and $\text{Tr}(X) = |\lambda|$ for any Hermitian matrix X with eigenvalues λ . For the tetrahedral Horn's problem, a set of tetrahedral eigenvalues $(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi)$ necessarily satisfy four *trace conditions*:

$$|\alpha| + |\beta| = |\gamma|, \quad |\beta| + |\delta| = |\phi|, \quad |\delta| + |\gamma| = |\epsilon|, \quad |\alpha| + |\phi| = |\epsilon|. \quad (7)$$

`{eq:tet_trace_conds}`

Comparing the tetrahedral trace conditions (Eq. (7)) with the $d = 1$ case of the tetrahedral Horn's problem (Eq. (1)), we see that a sextuple of eigenvalues $(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi)$ can only be tetrahedral if their traces, $(|\alpha|, |\beta|, |\gamma|, |\delta|, |\epsilon|, |\phi|)$, are tetrahedral.

2.2 Symmetries

sec:symmetries

There are numerous types of symmetries present in the statement of Problem 1. The purpose of this section is to describe the scaling, inversion, tetrahedral, and shifting symmetries of the problem. These symmetries can, in many cases, be used to simplify the problem by selecting a canonical representative of the corresponding equivalence class; in other cases, it will be useful to leave Problem 1 as stated. Later we will comment on the possibility of additional hidden symmetries not previously mentioned.

Proposition 4 (Scaling symmetry). *Let $(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi)$ be a sextuple of candidate eigenvalues and let $s \in (0, \infty)$ be a positive real number. Then the scaled eigenvalues, $(s\alpha, s\beta, s\gamma, s\delta, s\epsilon, s\phi)$, are tetrahedral if and only if the original, unscaled eigenvalues $(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi)$ are tetrahedral.*

Proof. The statement follows from the fact that $\text{eig}(sX) = s \text{eig}(X)$ holds for all Hermitian matrices X and positive scalars s and that each of the constraints in Eq. (1) are homogeneous in the six Hermitian matrices (A, B, C, D, E, F) ; for example, we have $sA + sB - sC = 0$ if and only if $s(A + B - C) = 0$ if and only if $A + B - C = 0$. $\square$

One may wonder with or not it is possible to extend the the scaling symmetry to consider scaling by negative $s < 0$. Indeed, this can be accomplished, provided one accounts for the fact that negating a Hermitian matrices both negates and reverses the order of its eigenvalues.

prop:inversion

Proposition 5 (Inversion symmetry). *Let $(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi)$ be a sextuple of candidate eigenvalues. Given any list of non-increasing eigenvalues $\lambda = (\lambda_1 \geq \dots \geq \lambda_d)$, let λ^* denote the inverted list of resorted and negated eigenvalues: $\lambda^* = (-\lambda_d \geq \dots \geq -\lambda_1)$. Then $(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi)$ are tetrahedral if and only if $(\alpha^*, \beta^*, \gamma^*, \delta^*, \epsilon^*, \phi^*)$ are tetrahedral.*

Proof. The statement holds because (i) (A, B, C, D, E, F) satisfy Eq. (1) if and only if $(A', B', C', D', E', F') := (-A, -B, -C, -D, -E, -F)$ satisfy Eq. (1), and (ii) $\text{eig}(X) = \lambda$ if and only if $\text{eig}(-X) = \lambda^*$. $\square$

The inversion symmetry Proposition 5 is just one element belonging to a group of 48 symmetries consisting of inversions of eigenvalues, $\lambda \rightarrow \lambda^*$, or permutations of elements in the sextuple $(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi)$.

Theorem 6 (Tetrahedral symmetry). *The sextuple $(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi)$ of eigenvalues are tetrahedral if and only if any (and thus all) of the following sextuples of eigenvalues are tetrahedral:*

$$\begin{pmatrix} \delta & \beta & \phi & \alpha & \epsilon & \gamma \\ \alpha^* & \gamma & \beta & \delta & \phi & \epsilon \\ \beta^* & \alpha^* & \gamma^* & \epsilon & \delta & \phi \end{pmatrix}. \quad (8)$$

Moreover, these three symmetries generate a finite group of order 48. Furthermore, this finite group full subgroup of all $6! \times 2^6 = 46,080$ possible “signed” permutations.

Proof.

$$\begin{pmatrix} D & B & F & A & E & C \\ -A & C & B & D & F & E \\ -B & -A & -C & E & D & F \end{pmatrix} \quad (9)$$

For example if $(A', B', C', D', E', F') = (-A, C, B, D, F, E)$, then

$$A' + B' - C' = -A + C - B = 0 \quad (10)$$

$$B' + D' - F' = C + D - E = 0 \quad (11)$$

$$C' + D' - E' = B + D - F = 0 \quad (12)$$

$$A' + F' - E' = -A + E - F = 0 \quad (13)$$

$$(14)$$

$$\begin{pmatrix} A & B & C \\ D & E & F \end{pmatrix} \quad (15)$$

$\square$

prop:shifting

Proposition 7 (Shifting symmetry). *Let $(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi)$ be a sextuple of candidate eigenvalues and let $x, y, z \in \mathbb{R}$ be fixed. Given any list of non-increasing eigenvalues $\lambda = (\lambda_1 \geq \dots \geq \lambda_d)$, let $\lambda + x := (\lambda_1 + x \geq \dots \geq \lambda_d + x)$. Then define shifted eigenvalues by the formula*

$$\begin{aligned} \tilde{\alpha} &:= \alpha + x, & \tilde{\beta} &:= \beta + y, & \tilde{\gamma} &:= \gamma + x + y, & \text{\textit{\{eq:shifted_tet_eigenvalues\}}} \\ \tilde{\delta} &:= \delta + z, & \tilde{\epsilon} &:= \epsilon + x + y + z, & \tilde{\phi} &:= \phi + y + z. \end{aligned} \quad (16)$$

The shifted eigenvalues $(\tilde{\alpha}, \tilde{\beta}, \tilde{\gamma}, \tilde{\delta}, \tilde{\epsilon}, \tilde{\phi})$ are tetrahedral if and only if the unshifted eigenvalues $(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi)$ are tetrahedral.

Proof. Given a Hermitian matrix X with eigenvalues $\text{eig}(X) = \lambda$ and a constant $x \in \mathbb{R}$, the eigenvalues of $X + xI$ (where I is the identity matrix) are

$$\text{eig}(X + xI) = \lambda + x = (\lambda_1 + x \geq \dots \geq \lambda_d + x). \quad (17)$$

The statement then follows from Example 2 because

$$(A + xI, B + yI, C + (x + y)I, D + zI, E + (x + y + z)I, F + (y + z)I) \quad (18)$$

satisfy the tetrahedral constraints in Eq. (1) if and only if (A, B, C, D, E, F) satisfy the tetrahedral constraints in Eq. (1) $\square$

As a corollary of the shifting symmetries (Proposition 7) one concludes that to solve the tetrahedral Horn's problem, in a certain sense, it suffices to solve the tetrahedral Horn's problem merely for traceless matrices (Corollary 8) or, alternatively, for positive definite or positive semidefinite matrices (Corollary 9). *cor:traceless*

Corollary 8 (Traceless). *Let $(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi)$ be a sextuple of candidate eigenvalues and for any list of d eigenvalues $\lambda = (\lambda_1 \geq \dots \geq \lambda_d)$, let $\lambda^0 := \lambda - |\lambda|/d$ denote the traceless list of eigenvalues obtained by shifting λ by $-|\lambda|/d$. Then $(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi)$ are tetrahedral if and only if (i) their traces $(|\alpha|, |\beta|, |\gamma|, |\delta|, |\epsilon|, |\phi|)$ are tetrahedral (they satisfy Eq. (7)) and (ii) $(\alpha^0, \beta^0, \gamma^0, \delta^0, \epsilon^0, \phi^0)$ are tetrahedral.*

Proof. This “only if” portion of the statement follows from both the tetrahedral trace conditions (Eq. (7)) and applications of the shifting symmetry Proposition 7 with (x, y, z) values

$$x = -d^{-1} \text{Tr}(A), \quad y = -d^{-1} \text{Tr}(B) \quad z = -d^{-1} \text{Tr}(D). \quad (19)$$

The “if” portion of the statement follows from the shifting symmetry applied to the negated (x, y, z) values. $\square$

The next corollary of the shifting symmetry proves that to solve the tetrahedral Horn's problem it suffices to solve the tetrahedral Horn's problem for positive definite spectra only. Indeed, one can simply take the shifting parameters (x, y, z) appearing in Proposition 7 to be sufficiently large. The following corollary establishes, in a certain sense, the minimum shifting required to ensure strictly positive eigenvalues for all six Hermitian matrices (assuming some other basic inequalities hold). Note that in subsequent sections we will often explicitly assume the candidate eigenvalues $(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi)$ are either non-negative or positive for the sake of technical convenience or sometimes to establish a connection with density matrices from quantum theory (which are positive semidefinite Hermitian matrices with unit trace). *cor:psd*

Corollary 9 (Positive definite). *If $(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi)$ are a tetrahedral sextuple of eigenvalues, then necessarily the smallest eigenvalues satisfy*

$$\gamma_d \geq \alpha_d + \beta_d, \quad \phi_d \geq \beta_d + \delta_d, \quad \epsilon_d \geq \delta_d + \gamma_d, \quad \epsilon_d \geq \alpha_d + \phi_d. \quad (20) \quad \text{\textit{\{eq:min_eig_ineqs\}}}$$

Moreover, if $(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi)$ are a sextuple of candidate eigenvalues satisfying Eq. (20), then for any $(x, y, z) \in \mathbb{R}^3$ satisfying

$$x > -\alpha_d, \quad y > -\beta_d, \quad z > -\delta_d, \quad (21) \quad \text{\textit{\{eq:positive_shift\}}}$$

the resulting shifted eigenvalues $(\tilde{\alpha}, \tilde{\beta}, \tilde{\gamma}, \tilde{\delta}, \tilde{\epsilon}, \tilde{\phi})$ (given by Eq. (16)) are all positive.

Proof. That tetrahedral eigenvalues satisfy Eq. (20) follows from four applications of the well-known inequality $\gamma_d \geq \alpha_d + \beta_d$ for the trigonal Horn's problem where $C = A + B$ [Bha01]. As a reminder, the smallest eigenvalue λ_d of a matrix X is characterized by a minimization: $\lambda_d = \min_{\|v\|=1} \langle v, Xv \rangle$ which produces

$$\gamma_d = \min_{\|v\|=1} \langle v, Cv \rangle = \min_{\|v\|=1} (\langle v, Av \rangle + \langle v, Bv \rangle) \geq \min_{\|v\|=1} \langle v, Av \rangle + \min_{\|w\|=1} \langle w, Bw \rangle = \alpha_d + \beta_d. \quad (22)$$

Four applications of this inequality produces Eq. (20). Now if (x, y, z) satisfy Eq. (21), we have for all j

$$\alpha_j + x \geq \alpha_d + x > 0, \quad (23)$$

meaning $\alpha + x = (\alpha_1 + x \geq \dots \geq \lambda_d + x)$ is strictly positive. Similar statements hold for $\beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon$ and ϕ ; for instance, for all j ,

$$\epsilon_j + x + y + z \geq \epsilon_d + x + y + z > \epsilon_d - \alpha_d - \beta_d - \delta_d \geq 0, \quad (24)$$

meaning $\epsilon + x + y + z$ is strictly positive also. $\square$

TODO: Describe tetrahedral symmetries, and conjectured generalized Regge symmetries [Boa07; MS18].

2.3 The case of 2×2 Hermitian matrices

sec:d_2

In the context of the $d = 2$ tetrahedral eigenvalue problem, each traceless 2×2 matrix, X , may be identified with a three-dimensional vector $(x_1, x_2, x_3) \in \mathbb{R}^3$ using the standard Pauli-matrix basis:

$$X = x_1 \sigma_1 + x_2 \sigma_2 + x_3 \sigma_3 = \begin{pmatrix} x_3 & x_1 - ix_2 \\ x_1 + ix_2 & -x_3 \end{pmatrix}. \quad (25)$$

The eigenvalues of X are then determined by the Euclidean length of the vector (x_1, x_2, x_3) :

$$\text{eig}(X) = \lambda \begin{pmatrix} x_3 & x_1 - ix_2 \\ x_1 + ix_2 & -x_3 \end{pmatrix} = (\|x\|, -\|x\|), \quad \text{where,} \quad \|x\| = \sqrt{x_1^2 + x_2^2 + x_3^2}. \quad (26)$$

Now, for the special case of the tetrahedral eigenvalue constraint problem, one can assume the sextuple of eigenvalues are determined by a sextuple of non-negative real numbers $(a, b, c, d, e, f) \in \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}^6$ such that

$$\alpha = (a, -a), \quad \beta = (b, -b), \quad \gamma = (c, -c), \quad \delta = (d, -d), \quad \epsilon = (e, -e), \quad \phi = (f, -f). \quad (27)$$

Using this parameterization, it can be shown that the constraints imposed in Problem 1 precisely describe the space of all possible edge-lengths (a, b, c, d, e, f) of a genuine Euclidean tetrahedron in $\mathbb{R}^3$ [Ric02]; namely, the conjunction of a quadruplet of triangle-inequalities,

$$|a - b| \leq c \leq a + b, \quad |b - d| \leq f \leq b + d, \quad |d - c| \leq e \leq d + c, \quad |a - f| \leq e \leq a + f, \quad (28)$$

together with a single non-linear constraint of the form

$$D(a, b, c, d, e, f) = \frac{1}{288} \det \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 & 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 & a^2 & e^2 & c^2 \\ 1 & a^2 & 0 & f^2 & b^2 \\ 1 & e^2 & f^2 & 0 & d^2 \\ 1 & c^2 & b^2 & d^2 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \geq 0. \quad (29)$$

The quantity $D(a, b, c, d, e, f)$ is known as a Cayley-Menger determinant and, when positive, is equal to square of the volume of the corresponding tetrahedron [SJS18]. Figure 2 depicts a three-dimensional projection of the solution space described by Eq. (28) and Eq. (29).

Remark 10. For 2×2 Hermitian matrices it is possible to visualize the set of eigenvalues (in the same (a, b, c, d, e, f) coordinates used above) which are known to be non-tetrahedral on the basis that they violate Eq. (56). Specifically, consider the *minimal* shifting of the traceless eigenvalues in Eq. (27), i.e.,

$$\begin{aligned} \alpha &= (2a, 0), & \beta &= (2b, 0), & \gamma &= (a + b + c, a + b - c), \\ \delta &= (2d, 0), & \epsilon &= (a + b + d + e, a + b + d - e), & \phi &= (b + d + f, b + d - f). \end{aligned} \quad (30)$$

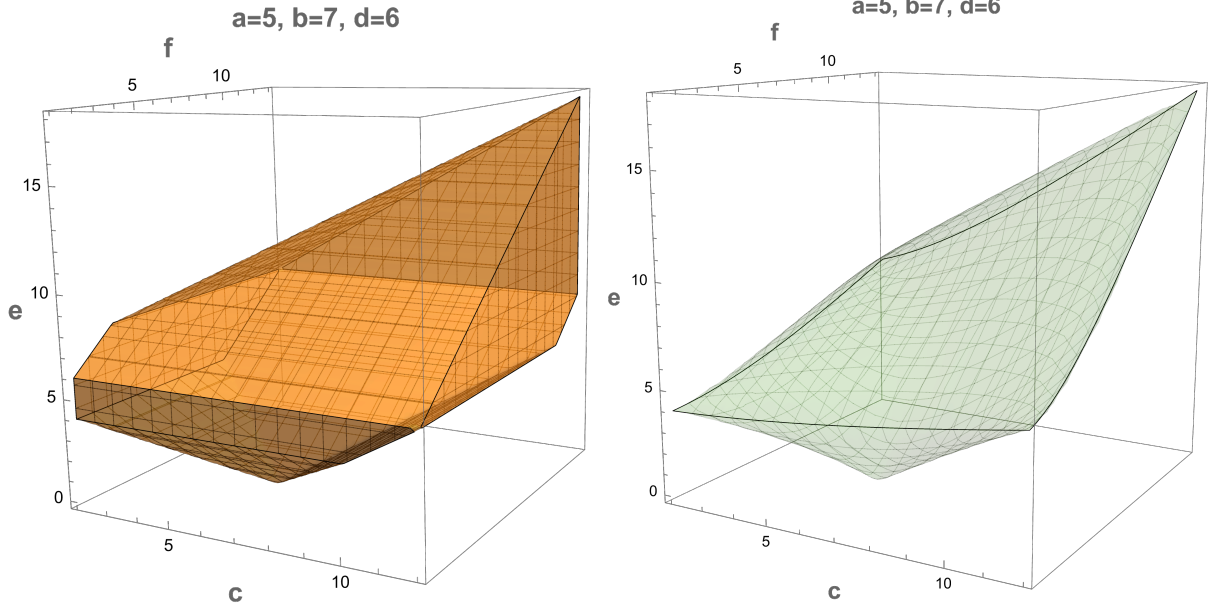


Figure 2: Projections of admissible side-lengths (a, b, c, d, e, f) for Euclidean tetrahedron along the coordinates $(a, b, d) = (5, 7, 6)$ (Left) The polyhedron of values (c, e, f) satisfying the triangle inequalities for each face Eq. (28). (Right) The set of all values (c, e, f) satisfying both Eq. (28) and Eq. (29).

With respect to these coordinates, Eq. (56) becomes

$$\begin{aligned}
 F(a, b, c, d, e, f) := & -(a + b + c) \log(a + b + c) - (a + b - c) \log(a + b - c) \\
 & - (b + d + f) \log(b + d + f) - (b + d - f) \log(b + d - f) \\
 & + (a + b + d + e) \log(a + b + d + e) + (a + b + d - e) \log(a + b + d - e) \\
 & + (2b) \log(2b) \geq 0
 \end{aligned} \tag{31}$$

See Fig. 3 for a depiction of the region violating Eq. (31).

2.4 Comparison with the CSW inequality

At this stage, it is worth comparing the inequality in Eq. (56) to a similar inequality derived by Christandl, Şahinoğlu, and Walter [CSW18], which holds for tetrahedral eigenvalues $(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi)$ which are non-negative and sufficiently small in the sense that $\lambda_1 + |\lambda| \leq 1$:

$$h(|\gamma|) + |\gamma| S(\bar{\gamma}) + h(|\phi|) + |\phi| S(\bar{\phi}) - h(|\beta|) - |\beta| S(\bar{\beta}) - h(|\epsilon|) - |\epsilon| S(\bar{\epsilon}) \geq 0. \tag{32}$$

The inequality appearing in Eq. (56) is equivalent to the following by Eq. (136):

$$-|\gamma| \log |\gamma| + |\gamma| S(\bar{\gamma}) - |\phi| \log |\phi| + |\phi| S(\bar{\phi}) + |\beta| \log |\beta| - |\beta| S(\bar{\beta}) + |\epsilon| \log |\epsilon| - |\epsilon| S(\bar{\epsilon}) \geq 0. \tag{33}$$

The difference between Eq. (32) and Eq. (33) is captured by a formal substitution replacing the binary entropy $h(|\lambda|)$ with the expression $-|\lambda| \log |\lambda|$. We note that it is possible to derive Eq. (33) from Eq. (32) by a down-scaling argument. Specifically, while the set of tetrahedral eigenvalues is closed under scaling all eigenvalues by a non-negative r ,

$$(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi) \mapsto (r\alpha, r\beta, r\gamma, r\delta, r\epsilon, r\phi), \tag{34}$$

the form and positivity of Eq. (32) is *not* invariant under scaling by r . Define q_r by the formula

$$q_r := r^{-1} (h(|r\gamma|) + h(|r\phi|) - h(|r\beta|) - h(|r\epsilon|)). \tag{35}$$

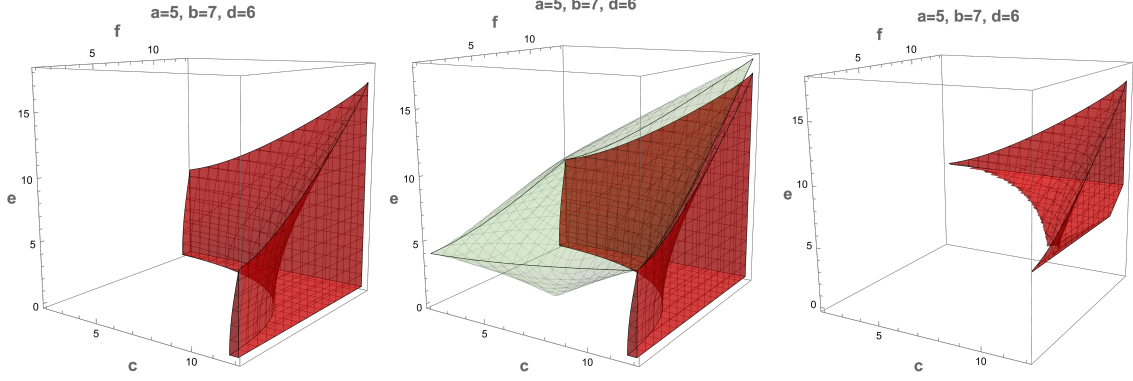


Figure 3: (Left) The region for which (c, e, f) violates Eq. (31) with $(a, b, c) = (5, 7, 6)$. (Middle) Comparing the region of tetrahedral (c, e, f) with those which violate Eq. (31). (Right) The values of (c, e, f) satisfying Eq. (28) but violating Eq. (31). [fig:ssa_extra_mileage](#)

Letting $r \in (0, 1)$ be positive and small, we see that

$$r^{-1}h(|r\lambda|) = |\lambda| (1 - \log r) - |\lambda| \log |\lambda| + O(r^2) \quad (36)$$

which implies the following limit holds when $|\gamma| + |\phi| = |\beta| + |\epsilon|$:

$$q_0 := \lim_{r \rightarrow 0} q_r = -|\gamma| \log |\gamma| - |\phi| \log |\phi| + |\beta| \log |\beta| + |\epsilon| \log |\epsilon|. \quad (37)$$

In summary, by scaling down the eigenvalues in Eq. (32) by $r \in (0, 1)$ according to Eq. (34) and then scaling up Eq. (32) by multiplication by r^{-1} and taking the limit as $r \rightarrow \infty$, one recovers Eq. (33). Moreover, it can be shown that $q_r \geq q_0$ for all r and thus Eq. (33) is strictly stronger than Eq. (32). To prove this, we see that the trace equalities imply

$$\begin{aligned} q_r - q_0 &= r^{-1}(1 - r|\beta|) \log(1 - r|\beta|) + r^{-1}(1 - r|\epsilon|) \log(1 - r|\epsilon|) \\ &\quad - r^{-1}(1 - r|\gamma|) \log(1 - r|\gamma|) - r^{-1}(1 - r|\phi|) \log(1 - r|\phi|). \end{aligned} \quad (38)$$

Approximating $-(1 - x) \log(1 - x)$ by a Taylor series for $x \approx 0$,

$$-(1 - x) \log(1 - x) = x - \frac{x^2}{2} + O(x^3), \quad (39)$$

produces

$$q_r - q_0 = \frac{r}{2}(|\beta|^2 + |\epsilon|^2 - |\gamma|^2 - |\phi|^2) + O(r^2) = r|\alpha||\delta| + O(r^2) \quad (40)$$

which implies $q_r > q_0$ and least for sufficiently small r . To prove $q_r > q_0$ holds for all r , by continuity, it therefore suffices to show that the gradient of $q_r - q_0$ with respect to r never changes sign for $r > 0$.

$$\begin{aligned} \partial_r(q_r - q_0) &= \frac{1}{r^2} (\log(1 - r|\gamma|) + \log(1 - r|\phi|) - \log(1 - r|\beta|) - \log(1 - r|\epsilon|)) \\ &= \frac{1}{r^2} \log \left(\frac{(1 - r|\gamma|)(1 - r|\phi|)}{(1 - r|\beta|)(1 - r|\epsilon|)} \right). \end{aligned} \quad (41)$$

Thus the gradient $\partial_r(q_r - q_0)$ vanishes only if the argument of the above logarithm is one, or equivalently when

$$0 = (1 - r|\gamma|)(1 - r|\phi|) - (1 - r|\beta|)(1 - r|\epsilon|) = r^2(|\gamma||\phi| - |\epsilon||\beta|) = r^2|\alpha||\delta|. \quad (42)$$

As we are implicitly assuming $|\alpha| \neq 0$ and $|\delta| \neq 0$, we see that the gradient of $q_r - q_0$ never changes when $r > 0$ and thus $q_r - q_0$ is increasing with increasing $r > 0$.

3 Submodular inequalities on PSD matrices

[lem:quadratic_ineq](#)

Lemma 11. *Let $A, B, C \geq 0$ be positive semidefinite Hermitian matrices, then*

$$\sum_j \lambda_j(A+B)^2 + \sum_j \lambda_j(B+C)^2 \leq \sum_j \lambda_j(B)^2 + \sum_j \lambda_j(A+B+C)^2. \quad (43)$$

Proof. Note that $\sum_j \lambda_j(X)^2 = \text{Tr}[X^2]$ for any Hermitian operator X . Therefore,

$$\begin{aligned} & \text{Tr}[(B)^2] + \text{Tr}[(A+B+C)^2] - \text{Tr}[(A+B)^2] - \text{Tr}[(B+C)^2] \\ &= (\text{Tr}[B^2]) + (\text{Tr}[A^2] + \text{Tr}[B^2] + \text{Tr}[C^2] + 2\text{Tr}[AB] + 2\text{Tr}[BC] + 2\text{Tr}[AC]) \\ &\quad - (\text{Tr}[A^2] + \text{Tr}[B^2] + 2\text{Tr}[AB]) - (\text{Tr}[B^2] + \text{Tr}[C^2] + 2\text{Tr}[BC]) \\ &= 2\text{Tr}[AC]. \end{aligned} \quad (44)$$

Since $A, C \geq 0$ are both positive semidefinite, we also have $\text{Tr}[AC] \geq 0$ which proves the claim. $\square$

Bouhtou, Gaubert, and Sagnol claim to prove the following family of inequalities [\[BGS08, Lemma 5.3\]](#). [lem:bouhtou_ineq](#)

Lemma 12. *Let $A, B, C \geq 0$ be positive semidefinite Hermitian matrices and let $p \in [0, 1]$. Then*

$$\sum_j \lambda_j(A+B)^p + \sum_j \lambda_j(B+C)^p \geq \sum_j \lambda_j(B)^p + \sum_j \lambda_j(A+B+C)^p. \quad (45)$$

The following operator inequality can be used to prove a number of inequalities [\[TCL11, Lemma 2.2\]](#). [lem:mme_operator_ineq](#)

Lemma 13. *Let $A, B, C \geq 0$ be positive semidefinite matrices and let k be a positive integer. Then*

$$(A+B+C)^{\otimes k} + B^{\otimes k} \geq (A+B)^{\otimes k} + (B+C)^{\otimes k}. \quad (46)$$

Proof. The result is obtained from applying a non-commutative multinomial expansion and noting that every summand on the right-hand-side above also appears on the left-hand-side above. $\square$

To obtain an inequality which depends only on the eigenvalues of $B, A+B, B+C$, and $A+B+C$, one can simply pair the positive semidefinite operator in Lemma 13 with an $\text{SU}(d)$ -equivariant and positive semidefinite operator: [cor:isotypic_ineq](#)

Corollary 14. *Let $A, B, C \geq 0$ be positive semidefinite matrices and let $\lambda \vdash k$ be a Young diagram with k boxes. Then*

$$\text{Tr}[P_\lambda(A+B+C)^{\otimes k}] + \text{Tr}[P_\lambda B^{\otimes k}] \geq \text{Tr}[P_\lambda(A+B)^{\otimes k}] + \text{Tr}[P_\lambda(B+C)^{\otimes k}]. \quad (47)$$

As a special case of the previous corollary, we obtain an inequality which complements Lemma 11. [lem:quadratic_ineq_dual](#)

Corollary 15. *Let $A, B, C \geq 0$ be positive semidefinite Hermitian matrices, then*

$$\text{Tr}[A+B]^2 - \text{Tr}[(A+B)^2] + \text{Tr}[B+C]^2 - \text{Tr}[(B+C)^2] \leq \text{Tr}[B]^2 - \text{Tr}[B^2] + \text{Tr}[A+B+C]^2 - \text{Tr}[(A+B+C)^2]. \quad (48)$$

Proof. This result is a special case of Corollary 14 below when $\lambda = (1, 1)$ because

$$\text{Tr}[P_{(1,1)} X^{\otimes 2}] = \frac{1}{2} (\text{Tr}(X)^2 - \text{Tr}(X^2)). \quad (49)$$

$\square$

Paksoy, Turkmen, and Zhang proved a family of polynomial inequalities which are generally not functions of just the eigenvalues [\[PTZ14\]](#). These inequalities are in terms a so-called generalized matrix function first defined by Marcus and Minc [\[MM65\]](#).

Definition 16 (Generalized matrix function). Let H be a subgroup of S_n and let χ be an irreducible character of H . The *generalized matrix function* for the character χ of H is

$$d_\chi^H(X) = \sum_{\sigma \in H} \chi(\sigma) \prod_i X_{i, \sigma(i)} \quad (50)$$

The notion of a *generalized matrix function* generalizes the notion of an *immanant* (when $H = S_n$) which, in turn, contains as special cases the notion of a permanent and determinant [HM21]. thm:ptz_ineqs

Theorem 17. Let $A, B, C \geq 0$ be positive semidefinite $n \times n$ matrices and let H be a subgroup of S_n with irreducible character χ . Then

$$d_\chi^H(A + B + C) + d_\chi^H(B) \geq d_\chi^H(A + B) + d_\chi^H(B + C). \quad (51)$$

Proof. See [PTZ14]. □

As a corollary of Theorem 17, we obtain the following determinant and permanent inequalities.

Corollary 18. Let $A, B, C \geq 0$ be positive semidefinite matrices. Then

$$\det(A + B + C) + \det(B) \geq \det(A + B) + \det(B + C), \quad (52)$$

$$\text{per}(A + B + C) + \text{per}(B) \geq \text{per}(A + B) + \text{per}(B + C). \quad (53)$$

Note that with the exception of the above determinant inequality, the inequalities provided by Theorem 17 are generally not equivalent to inequalities involving only eigenvalues.

One also has another determinant inequality which is non-linear in determinants [TCL11, Lemma 2.3]. lem:det_prod_ineq

Lemma 19. Let $A, B, C \geq 0$ be positive semidefinite matrices. Then

$$\det(A + B + C) \det(B) \leq \det(A + B) \det(B + C). \quad (54)$$

Note that Lemma 19 can be seen as a special of Lemma 12 in the limit as $p \rightarrow 0$; the derivative of Lemma 12 in p at $p = 0$ yields

$$\sum_j \log \lambda_j(A + B) + \sum_j \log \lambda_j(B + C) \geq \sum_j \log \lambda_j(B) + \sum_j \log \lambda_j(A + B + C), \quad (55)$$
{eq:bouhtou_ineq_p_zero}

which is equivalent to Lemma 19. thm:ssa_ineq

Theorem 20. Let $A, B, C \geq 0$ be positive semidefinite Hermitian matrices, then

$$\sum_j \lambda_j(A + B) \log \lambda_j(A + B) + \sum_j \lambda_j(B + C) \log \lambda_j(B + C) \quad (56)$$
{eq:ssa_like_ineq}

$$\leq \sum_j \lambda_j(B) \log \lambda_j(B) + \sum_j \lambda_j(A + B + C) \log \lambda_j(A + B + C). \quad (57)$$

The most comprehensive result concerning the eigenvalues of partial sums of Hermitian matrices we have encountered thus far is [Sag13, Proposition 2.3] which provides the following result. thm:sagnol_ineq

Theorem 21. Let $A, B, C \geq 0$ be positive semidefinite Hermitian matrices and let f be a real valued and differentiable function over the non-negative real numbers $\mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}$ such that the derivative of f is an operator monotone function over the positive real numbers $\mathbb{R}_{> 0}$. Then the following inequality holds

$$\text{Tr } f(A + B + C) + \text{Tr } f(B) \geq \text{Tr } f(A + B) + \text{Tr } f(B + C). \quad (58)$$
{eq:sagnol_ineq}

Proof. The following proof is a rough summary of the proof found in [Sag13, Section 2.1]. Let X, Y be positive semidefinite and consider following difference:

$$F(Y|X) := \text{Tr } f(X + Y) - \text{Tr } f(Y). \quad (59)$$

The inequality in Eq. (58) is thus equivalent to $F(C|B) \leq F(A + C|B)$. To prove Eq. (58) it suffices to prove that the value of $F(Y|X)$ is a non-decreasing function under $Y \mapsto Y + Z$ for arbitrary positive semidefinite X, Y , and Z . To establish the claim, let $\epsilon > 0$ be small and let $Z = \epsilon W$ for non-zero positive semidefinite W . It can be shown² that

$$(\partial_Y F(Y|X))(W) := \lim_{\epsilon \rightarrow 0} \frac{1}{\epsilon} (F(Y + \epsilon W|X) - F(Y|X)) \quad (60)$$

$$= \lim_{\epsilon \rightarrow 0} \frac{1}{\epsilon} (\text{Tr } f(X + Y + \epsilon W) - \text{Tr } f(Y + \epsilon W) - \text{Tr } f(X + Y) + \text{Tr } f(Y)) \quad (61)$$

$$= \text{Tr } [(f'(X + Y) - f'(Y)) W]. \quad (62)$$

Using the assumption that f' is an operator monotone together with $X + Y \geq Y$ (because $X \geq 0$), we have $f'(X + Y) \geq f'(Y)$ and thus $f'(X + Y) - f'(Y) \geq 0$. Therefore $(\partial_Y F(Y|X))(W) \geq 0$ for all W and thus $F(Y|X)$ is non-decreasing with respect to $Y \mapsto Y + Z$ as desired. $\square$

As corollaries one obtains some of the previously mentioned inequalities for various functions f satisfying the conditions of the theorem; for example, choosing $f(x) = x \log x$ yields Theorem 20, while choosing $f(x) = -x^p$ for $p \in (0, 1]$ yields Lemma 12, and choosing $f(x) = x^p$ for $p \in (1, 2]$ yields the following.

Corollary 22. *Let $A, B, C \geq 0$ be positive semidefinite Hermitian matrices and let $p \in (1, 2]$. Then*

$$\sum_j \lambda_j(A + B)^p + \sum_j \lambda_j(B + C)^p \leq \sum_j \lambda_j(B)^p + \sum_j \lambda_j(A + B + C)^p. \quad (63)$$

TC: On Sept. 18th, I came across an interesting discussion on [mathoverflow](https://mathoverflow.net/questions/257562/a-determinant-inequality) <https://mathoverflow.net/questions/257562/a-determinant-inequality> which appears deeply related to the topic of submodular inequalities. In that post the following result is stated without explicit proof and is based on the theory of so-called “hyperbolic polynomials” p and their real roots λ_i . There are a handful of conjectured inequalities on the page. For example, it seems to prove

$$E_k(B)E_k(A + B + C) \leq E_k(A + B)E_k(B + C) \quad (64)$$

where $E_k(X) = e_k(\text{eig}(X))$ where E_k is the k th elementary symmetric polynomial.

Remark 23. There is also the paper by Lami et al. which investigates submodular inequalities of functions of blocks of positive matrices [Lam+17].

²The statement follows, without loss of generality, by assuming that all the matrices involved are positive *definite*. This assumption is permitted because f is assumed continuous and the eigenvalues of a matrix are also continuous functions (see [Sag13] for a detailed explanation).

4 Asymptotics of $SU(d)$ $6j$ operators

The purpose of this section is to derive some upper and lower bounds on generalized $6j$ symbol for $SU(d)$ in relation to the existence or non-existence of Hermitian operators satisfying the tetrahedral relations Eq. (1). This section essentially constitutes a generalization of the proof techniques in the “quantum-information-theoretic” approach taken in [Chr08]. Specifically, the results of this section are derived from considering a type of pseudo-commutative binomial expansion of tensor powers of sums of Hermitian operators and applying spectrum estimation to the resulting terms.

4.1 Schur-Weyl decomposition & spectrum estimation

Throughout this section, we make use of the following decomposition of a tensor-power of a d -dimensional complex vector space.

Proposition 24 (Schur-Weyl decomposition). *Let n and d be positive integers. Then the decomposition of $(\mathbb{C}^d)^{\otimes n}$ into irreducible representations of $S_n \times SU(d)$, known as the Schur-Weyl decomposition is given by*

$$(\mathbb{C}^d)^{\otimes n} \cong \bigoplus_{\lambda \vdash_n} W_\lambda \otimes V_\lambda^d \quad \text{\textcolor{blue}{\small{eq:schur_weyl_decomp}}} \quad (65)$$

where the direct sum is indexed by Young diagrams λ with n boxes and at most $d - 1$ rows.

The following result constrains the associated Schur-Weyl decomposition of the n -th tensor power, $X^{\otimes n}$, of a positive semidefinite Hermitian matrix X [Chr08; KW01].

\textcolor{blue}{prop:spec_est}

Proposition 25 (Spectrum estimation). *Let P_λ denote the Hermitian projection operator associated to the isotypic subspace indexed by $\lambda \vdash_n$ in Eq. (65) and let X be a positive semidefinite matrix with eigenvalues χ . Then*

$$\text{Tr}(P_\lambda X^{\otimes n}) \leq |\chi|^n \dim(V_\lambda^d) \exp(-nH(\bar{\lambda}|\bar{\chi})), \quad (66)$$

where $H(\bar{\lambda}|\bar{\chi})$ denotes the Kullback-Leibler divergence of $\bar{\lambda}$ from $\bar{\chi}$.

Proof. See [KW01] for a proof (noting that the $|\chi|^n$ term simply accounts for the possibility that $\text{Tr}(X) \neq 1$ because $\text{Tr}(X) = |\chi|$). $\square$

4.2 Schur-Weyl presentation of the $6j$ -operator

\textcolor{blue}{lem:schur_weyl_presentation}

Lemma 26. *Let x, y, z arbitrary positive integers and let $(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi)$ be Young diagrams of the following sizes:*

$$\begin{aligned} \alpha \vdash_d x, & \quad \beta \vdash_d y, & \quad \gamma \vdash_d x + y, \\ \delta \vdash_d z, & \quad \epsilon \vdash_d x + y + z, & \quad \phi \vdash_d y + z, \end{aligned} \quad \text{\textcolor{blue}{\small{eq:xyz_sized_young_diagrams}}} \quad (67)$$

and define corresponding projection operators acting on $(\mathbb{C}^d)^{\otimes x+y+z}$ by

$$\begin{aligned} \Pi_\alpha &:= P_\alpha \otimes \text{id}^{\otimes y} \otimes \text{id}^{\otimes z}, & \Pi_\beta &:= \text{id}^{\otimes x} \otimes P_\beta \otimes \text{id}^{\otimes z}, & \Pi_\gamma &:= P_\gamma \otimes \text{id}^{\otimes z}, \\ \Pi_\delta &:= \text{id}^{\otimes x} \otimes \text{id}^{\otimes y} \otimes P_\delta, & \Pi_\epsilon &:= P_\epsilon, & \Pi_\phi &:= \text{id}^{\otimes x} \otimes P_\phi. \end{aligned} \quad \text{\textcolor{blue}{\small{eq:extended_projs}}} \quad (68)$$

Then every pair of projection operators in the set $\{\Pi_\alpha, \Pi_\beta, \Pi_\gamma, \Pi_\delta, \Pi_\epsilon, \Pi_\phi\}$ is commuting with only possible exception being Π_γ and Π_ϕ . Then $\Pi_{\alpha\beta\delta\epsilon}^\gamma$ and $\Pi_{\alpha\beta\delta\epsilon}^\phi$, defined by

$$\begin{aligned} \Pi_{\alpha\beta\delta\epsilon}^\gamma &= \Pi_\gamma \Pi_\alpha \Pi_\beta \Pi_\delta \Pi_\epsilon, \\ \Pi_{\alpha\beta\delta\epsilon}^\phi &= \Pi_\phi \Pi_\alpha \Pi_\beta \Pi_\delta \Pi_\epsilon. \end{aligned} \quad \text{\textcolor{blue}{\small{eq:commuting_extended_projs}}} \quad (69)$$

are projection operators. Moreover, then $6j$ -operator $\left\{ \begin{smallmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{smallmatrix} \right\}$ has operator norm satisfying

$$\left\| \left\{ \begin{smallmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{smallmatrix} \right\} \right\|_\infty = \left\| \Pi_{\alpha\beta\delta\epsilon}^\phi \Pi_{\alpha\beta\delta\epsilon}^\gamma \right\|_\infty. \quad \text{\textcolor{blue}{\small{eq:ud_sixj_prod_proj_operator_norm}}} \quad (70)$$

and Hilbert-Schmidt norm satisfying

$$\left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_{\text{HS}}^2 = \frac{\text{Tr}(\Pi_{\alpha\beta\delta\epsilon}^\phi \Pi_{\alpha\beta\delta\epsilon}^\gamma)}{\dim(V_\epsilon^d) \dim(W_\alpha) \dim(W_\beta) \dim(W_\delta)}. \quad \text{\textcolor{blue}{\small{eq:ud_sixj_prod_proj_hs_norm}}} \quad (71)$$

Proof. That all projection operators except the pair (Π_γ, Π_ϕ) commute follows from elementary applications of Schur's lemma; the obstruction for the pair (Π_γ, Π_ϕ) is simply that Π_γ is not necessarily $\text{SU}(d)$ -equivariant with respect to the diagonal action on $\mathbb{C}^{\otimes y+z}$ and likewise Π_ϕ is not necessarily $\text{SU}(d)$ -equivariant with respect to the diagonal on $\mathbb{C}^{\otimes x+y}$. To prove both Eq. (70) and Eq. (71), it suffices to show there exists appropriately-typed isometries ι_I and ι_{II} such that

$$\Pi_{\alpha\beta\delta\epsilon}^\phi \Pi_{\alpha\beta\delta\epsilon}^\gamma = \iota_{II} \left(\text{id}_{V_\epsilon^d} \otimes \text{id}_{W_\alpha} \otimes \text{id}_{W_\beta} \otimes \text{id}_{W_\delta} \otimes \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{Bmatrix} \right) \iota_I^\dagger \quad \text{\textcolor{blue}{\small{eq:ud_sixj_prod_proj_iso}}} \quad (72)$$

This follows from the follow diagrammatic calculation TODO: Explain this.:

\(\square\)
\text{defn:Q_quantity}

Definition 27. Let (A, B, C, D, E, F) be a tetrahedral sextuple of non-zero positive semidefinite $d \times d$ Hermitian matrices with eigenvalues $(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi)$. Let x, y, z be arbitrary positive integers and define

$$\Omega := \frac{A^{\otimes x} \otimes B^{\otimes y} \otimes D^{\otimes z}}{|\alpha|^x |\beta|^y |\delta|^z}. \quad (74)$$

Let $(\alpha', \beta', \gamma', \delta', \epsilon', \phi')$ be Young diagrams with sizes determined by Eq. (67), and let $\Pi_{\alpha'\beta'\delta'\epsilon'}^{\gamma'}$ and $\Pi_{\alpha'\beta'\delta'\epsilon'}^{\phi'}$ be defined according to Eq. (69). Define $Q_{A,B,C,D,E,F}^{\alpha'\beta'\gamma'\delta'\epsilon'\phi'} \in \mathbb{C}$ by

$$Q_{A,B,C,D,E,F}^{\alpha'\beta'\gamma'\delta'\epsilon'\phi'} := \text{Tr}(\Pi_{\alpha'\beta'\delta'\epsilon'}^{\phi'} \Omega \Pi_{\alpha'\beta'\delta'\epsilon'}^{\gamma'}). \quad (75)$$

Proposition 28. Let everything be as in Definition 27. Then

$$Q_{A,B,C,D,E,F}^{\alpha'\beta'\gamma'\delta'\epsilon'\phi'} = \text{Tr}(\Pi_{\alpha'} \Pi_{\beta'} \Pi_{\gamma'} \Pi_{\delta'} \Pi_{\epsilon'} \Pi_{\phi'} \Omega), \quad \text{\textcolor{blue}{\small{eq:Q_alt}}} \quad (76)$$

and therefore

$$1 = \text{Tr}(\Omega) = \sum_{\alpha' \vdash_d x} \sum_{\beta' \vdash_d y} \sum_{\gamma' \vdash_d x+y} \sum_{\delta' \vdash_d z} \sum_{\epsilon' \vdash_d y+z} \sum_{\phi' \vdash_d x+y+z} Q_{A,B,C,D,E,F}^{\alpha' \beta' \gamma' \delta' \epsilon' \phi'} \quad \text{\textcolor{blue}{\small{eq:completeness_relation}}} \quad (77)$$

Moreover, the magnitude of $Q_{A,B,C,D,E,F}^{\alpha' \beta' \gamma' \delta' \epsilon' \phi'}$ can be upper bounded by either

$$\left| Q_{A,B,C,D,E,F}^{\alpha' \beta' \gamma' \delta' \epsilon' \phi'} \right| \leq (\text{Tr}(\Pi_{\alpha'} \Omega) \text{Tr}(\Pi_{\beta'} \Omega) \text{Tr}(\Pi_{\gamma'} \Omega) \text{Tr}(\Pi_{\delta'} \Omega) \text{Tr}(\Pi_{\epsilon'} \Omega) \text{Tr}(\Pi_{\phi'} \Omega))^{\frac{1}{6}}. \quad \text{\textcolor{blue}{\small{eq:Q_pre_upper_bound}}} \quad (78)$$

or

$$\left| Q_{A,B,C,D,E,F}^{\alpha' \beta' \gamma' \delta' \epsilon' \phi'} \right| \leq \left\| \Pi_{\alpha' \beta' \gamma' \delta' \epsilon'}^{\phi'} \Pi_{\alpha' \beta' \gamma' \delta' \epsilon'}^{\gamma'} \right\|_{\infty}. \quad \text{\textcolor{blue}{\small{eq:Q_sixj_upper_bound}}} \quad (79)$$

Proof. The proof of Eq. (76) and Eq. (77) follows from elementary properties of the projection operators defined in Lemma 26. Moreover, Eq. (79) follows because Ω is positive semidefinite and trace one. To prove Eq. (78), consider an application of the Cauchy-Schwarz inequality to the Hilbert-Schmidt inner product, $\langle X, Y \rangle = \text{Tr}(X^\dagger Y)$, whenever $X = \Omega^{\frac{1}{2}} \Pi_1$ and $Y = \Omega^{\frac{1}{2}} \Pi_2$ (where Π_1 and Π_2 are generic Hermitian projectors and Ω is positive semidefinite):

$$\begin{aligned} |\text{Tr}(\Pi_1 \Omega \Pi_2)|^2 &= \left| \text{Tr}((\Omega^{\frac{1}{2}} \Pi_1)^\dagger (\Omega^{\frac{1}{2}} \Pi_2)) \right|^2 = \left| \langle \Omega^{\frac{1}{2}} \Pi_1, \Omega^{\frac{1}{2}} \Pi_2 \rangle \right|^2 \\ &\leq \langle \Omega^{\frac{1}{2}} \Pi_1, \Omega^{\frac{1}{2}} \Pi_1 \rangle \langle \Omega^{\frac{1}{2}} \Pi_2, \Omega^{\frac{1}{2}} \Pi_2 \rangle = \text{Tr}(\Pi_1 \Omega) \text{Tr}(\Pi_2 \Omega) \end{aligned} \quad \text{\textcolor{blue}{\small{eq:biproj_ineq}}} \quad (80)$$

Letting $\Pi_1 = \Pi_{\phi'} \Pi_{\alpha'} \Pi_{\beta'}$ and $\Pi_2 = \Pi_{\gamma'} \Pi_{\delta'} \Pi_{\epsilon'}$ and applying Eq. (80) yields

$$\begin{aligned} \left| Q_{A,B,C,D,E,F}^{\alpha' \beta' \gamma' \delta' \epsilon' \phi'} \right|^6 &= |\text{Tr}[(\Pi_{\phi'} \Pi_{\alpha'} \Pi_{\beta'}) \Omega (\Pi_{\gamma'} \Pi_{\delta'} \Pi_{\epsilon'})]|^6 \\ &\leq \text{Tr}(\Pi_{\phi'} \Pi_{\alpha'} \Pi_{\beta'} \Omega)^3 \text{Tr}(\Pi_{\gamma'} \Pi_{\delta'} \Pi_{\epsilon'} \Omega)^3 \\ &\leq \text{Tr}(\Pi_{\phi'} \Omega) \text{Tr}(\Pi_{\alpha'} \Omega) \text{Tr}(\Pi_{\beta'} \Omega) \text{Tr}(\Pi_{\gamma'} \Omega) \text{Tr}(\Pi_{\delta'} \Omega) \text{Tr}(\Pi_{\epsilon'} \Omega). \end{aligned} \quad (81)$$

\text{\textcolor{blue}{\small{thm:Q_upper_bound}}} \quad \square

Theorem 29. Let everything be as in Definition 27 except fix x, y, z to be

$$x := \lceil n |\alpha| \rceil, \quad y := \lceil n |\beta| \rceil, \quad z := \lceil n |\delta| \rceil, \quad (82)$$

where n is a sufficiently large positive integer ensuring that x, y and z are non-zero. Then

$$\left| Q_{A,B,C,D,E,F}^{\alpha' \beta' \gamma' \delta' \epsilon' \phi'} \right| \leq p(n) \exp(-n I_{\alpha \beta \gamma \delta \epsilon \phi}^{\alpha' \beta' \gamma' \delta' \epsilon' \phi'} / 6). \quad \text{\textcolor{blue}{\small{eq:Q_upper_bound}}} \quad (83)$$

where $p(n)$ is a polynomial in n and where

$$I_{\alpha \beta \gamma \delta \epsilon \phi}^{\alpha' \beta' \gamma' \delta' \epsilon' \phi'} = |\alpha| H(\bar{\alpha}' | \bar{\alpha}) + |\beta| H(\bar{\beta}' | \bar{\beta}) + |\gamma| H(\bar{\gamma}' | \bar{\gamma}) + |\delta| H(\bar{\delta}' | \bar{\delta}) + |\epsilon| H(\bar{\epsilon}' | \bar{\epsilon}) + |\phi| H(\bar{\phi}' | \bar{\phi}). \quad (84)$$

TODO: Is this relative entropy deviation measure conceptually useful or is it best to relax the deviation measure to its geometric analogue using Pinsker's inequality?

Proof. To begin the proof, we consider x, y and z to be arbitrary positive integers. For each $\lambda' \in \{\alpha', \beta', \gamma', \delta', \epsilon', \phi'\}$, it is possible to upper-bound $\text{Tr}(\Pi_{\lambda'} \Omega)$ using the spectrum estimation technique Proposition 25. For a detailed example, we will consider the bound on $\text{Tr}(\Pi_{\gamma'} \Omega)$.

$$\text{Tr}(\Pi_{\gamma'} \Omega) = \frac{\text{Tr}[(P_{\gamma'} \otimes \text{id}^{\otimes z})(A^{\otimes x} \otimes B^{\otimes y} \otimes D^{\otimes z})]}{|\alpha|^x |\beta|^y |\delta|^z} = \frac{\text{Tr}[P_{\gamma'}(A^{\otimes x} \otimes B^{\otimes y})] |\delta|^z}{|\alpha|^x |\beta|^y |\delta|^z}. \quad (85)$$

Using the assumption that $C = A + B$, we have $C^{\otimes x+y} = (A + B)^{\otimes x+y}$ which implies

$$\text{Tr}(P_{\gamma'} C^{\otimes x+y}) = \sum_{k=0}^{x+y} \binom{x+y}{k} \text{Tr}(P_{\gamma'}(A^{\otimes k} \otimes B^{\otimes x+y-k})). \quad (86)$$

Here we have used the S_{x+y} -equivariance of $P_{\gamma'}$. Since each of the summands above are non-negative, we conclude for all $0 \leq k \leq x+y$ that

$$\mathrm{Tr}(P_{\gamma'} C^{\otimes x+y}) \geq \binom{x+y}{k} \mathrm{Tr}(P_{\gamma'} (A^{\otimes k} \otimes B^{\otimes x+y-k})). \quad (87)$$

Letting $k = x$ and rearranging yields

$$\mathrm{Tr}(P_{\gamma'} (A^{\otimes x} \otimes B^{\otimes y})) \leq \frac{x!y!}{(x+y)!} \mathrm{Tr}(P_{\gamma'} C^{\otimes x+y}). \quad (88)$$

Furthermore, spectrum estimation (Proposition 25) yields

$$\mathrm{Tr}(\Pi_{\gamma'} \Omega) \leq \frac{1}{|\alpha|^x |\beta|^y} \frac{x!y!}{(x+y)!} \mathrm{Tr}[P_{\gamma'} C^{\otimes x+y}], \quad (89)$$

$$\leq \frac{(|\alpha| + |\beta|)^{x+y}}{|\alpha|^x |\beta|^y} \frac{x!y!}{(x+y)!} \dim(V_{\gamma'}^d) \exp(-(x+y)H(\bar{\gamma}'|\bar{\gamma})). \quad (90)$$

Analogous calculations for $\lambda' \in \{\alpha', \beta', \gamma', \delta', \epsilon', \phi'\}$ produce the following set of upper bounds:

$$\mathrm{Tr}(\Pi_{\alpha'} \Omega) \leq \dim(V_{\alpha'}^d) \exp(-xH(\bar{\alpha}'|\bar{\alpha})), \quad (91)$$

$$\mathrm{Tr}(\Pi_{\beta'} \Omega) \leq \dim(V_{\beta'}^d) \exp(-yH(\bar{\beta}'|\bar{\beta})), \quad (92)$$

$$\mathrm{Tr}(\Pi_{\gamma'} \Omega) \leq \frac{(|\alpha| + |\beta|)^{x+y}}{|\alpha|^x |\beta|^y} \frac{x!y!}{(x+y)!} \dim(V_{\gamma'}^d) \exp(-(x+y)H(\bar{\gamma}'|\bar{\gamma})), \quad (93)$$

$$\mathrm{Tr}(\Pi_{\delta'} \Omega) \leq \dim(V_{\delta'}^d) \exp(-zH(\bar{\delta}'|\bar{\delta})), \quad (94)$$

$$\mathrm{Tr}(\Pi_{\epsilon'} \Omega) \leq \frac{(|\alpha| + |\beta| + |\delta|)^{x+y+z}}{|\alpha|^x |\beta|^y |\delta|^z} \frac{x!y!z!}{(x+y+z)!} \dim(V_{\epsilon'}^d) \exp(-(x+y+z)H(\bar{\epsilon}'|\bar{\epsilon})), \quad (95)$$

$$\mathrm{Tr}(\Pi_{\phi'} \Omega) \leq \frac{(|\beta| + |\delta|)^{x+y+z}}{|\beta|^y |\delta|^z} \frac{y!z!}{(y+z)!} \dim(V_{\phi'}^d) \exp(-(y+z)H(\bar{\phi}'|\bar{\phi})). \quad (96)$$

Our objective now will be to use the given values for x, y, z to prove the multinomial prefactors appearing in the bounds for γ', ϵ' , and ϕ' reasonably small compared to n . An application of Lemma 72 (when $k = 2$) implies the following bound

$$\frac{(|\alpha| + |\beta|)^{x+y}}{|\alpha|^x |\beta|^y} \frac{x!y!}{(x+y)!} \leq e^4 (n(|\alpha| + |\beta|) + 3)^2. \quad (97)$$

Moreover, using [CM06, Equation 7], we have

$$\dim(V_{\gamma'}^d) \leq (|\gamma'| + 1)^{d(d-1)/2} = (x+y+1)^{d(d-1)/2} < (n(|\alpha| + |\beta|) + 3)^{d(d-1)/2}. \quad (98)$$

Altogether, we can relax the bound on $\mathrm{Tr}(\Pi_{\gamma'} \Omega)$ to obtain

$$\mathrm{Tr}(\Pi_{\gamma'} \Omega) \leq e^4 (n|\epsilon| + 3)^{\frac{d(d-1)}{2}+2} \exp(-n|\gamma| H(\bar{\gamma}'|\bar{\gamma})). \quad (99)$$

Similar calculations for $\mathrm{Tr}(\Pi_{\epsilon'} \Omega)$ yields (noting that $k = 3$ when applying Lemma 72):

$$\mathrm{Tr}(\Pi_{\epsilon'} \Omega) \leq e^{16} (n|\epsilon| + 4)^{\frac{d(d-1)}{2}+3} \exp(-n|\epsilon| H(\bar{\epsilon}'|\bar{\epsilon})). \quad (100)$$

It is also not too difficult to see that the polynomial in n term associated to the upper bound on $\mathrm{Tr}(\Pi_{\epsilon'} \Omega)$ above is the largest such subexponential term and thus Eq. (83) indeed holds if we take $p(n)$ to be

$$p(n) = e^{16} (n|\epsilon| + 4)^{\frac{d(d-1)}{2}+3}. \quad (101)$$

□

Corollary 30. Let $(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi)$ be the eigenvalues of non-zero positive semidefinite tetrahedral Hermitian matrices (A, B, C, D, E, F) . Then there exists a sextuple of sequences of Young diagrams $(\alpha'_n, \beta'_n, \gamma'_n, \delta'_n, \epsilon'_n, \phi'_n)$ of sizes

$$\begin{aligned} \alpha'_n \vdash_d [n|\alpha|], & \quad \beta'_n \vdash_d [n|\beta|], & \quad \gamma'_n \vdash_d [n|\alpha| + [n|\beta|]], \\ \delta'_n \vdash_d [n|\delta|], & \quad \epsilon'_n \vdash_d [n|\alpha| + [n|\beta|] + [n|\delta|]], & \quad \phi'_n \vdash_d [n|\beta|] + [n|\delta|], \end{aligned} \quad (102)$$

satisfying (i) the convergence conditions

$$\begin{aligned} \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \bar{\alpha}'_n &= \bar{\alpha}, & \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \bar{\beta}'_n &= \bar{\beta}, & \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \bar{\gamma}'_n &= \bar{\gamma}, \\ \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \bar{\delta}'_n &= \bar{\delta}, & \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \bar{\epsilon}'_n &= \bar{\epsilon}, & \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \bar{\phi}'_n &= \bar{\phi}, \end{aligned} \quad (103)$$

and (ii) the lower bound

$$\left\| \left\{ \begin{array}{c} \alpha'_n \beta'_n \gamma'_n \\ \delta'_n \epsilon'_n \phi'_n \end{array} \right\} \right\|_{\infty} \geq \frac{1}{(n|\epsilon| + 4)^{6(d-1)}}. \quad (104)$$

Proof. For each n , it suffices to pick $(\alpha'_n, \beta'_n, \gamma'_n, \delta'_n, \epsilon'_n, \phi'_n)$ be the sextuple which maximizes the value of $\left| Q_{A,B,C,D,E,F}^{\alpha'_n \beta'_n \gamma'_n \delta'_n \epsilon'_n \phi'_n} \right|$. Such a choice will necessarily satisfy a lower bound due to the completeness relation Eq. (77). Specifically,

$$\left| Q_{A,B,C,D,E,F}^{\alpha'_n \beta'_n \gamma'_n \delta'_n \epsilon'_n \phi'_n} \right| \geq \frac{1}{q(n)} \quad (105)$$

where $q(n)$ is any upper bound on the number of possible summands in Eq. (77) viewed as a function of n . As there are at most $(k+1)^{d-1}$ Young diagrams with $d-1$ rows and size at most k , letting

$$q(n) = (n|\epsilon| + 4)^{6(d-1)} \quad (106)$$

ensures Eq. (105) holds because the size of ϵ'_n is at most $k = n|\epsilon| + 3$. Moreover, applying Eq. (83) yields

$$I_{\alpha\beta\gamma\delta\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha'_n \beta'_n \gamma'_n \delta'_n \epsilon'_n \phi'_n} \leq \frac{6}{n} (\log q(n) + \log p(n)) \xrightarrow{n \rightarrow \infty} 0 \quad (107)$$

and thus Eq. (103) holds because $H(\bar{\lambda}'|\bar{\lambda}) \geq 0$ with equality if and only if $\bar{\lambda}' = \bar{\lambda}$. Then Eq. (104) follows from Eq. (105) combined with Eq. (79) and Eq. (70). $\square$

Theorem 31. Let $(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi)$ be non-negative non-zero eigenvalues which are not tetrahedral. Then for all sequences of Young diagrams $(\alpha'_n, \beta'_n, \gamma'_n, \delta'_n, \epsilon'_n, \phi'_n)$ satisfying Eq. (102) and Eq. (103), we have

$$\left\| \left\{ \begin{array}{c} \alpha'_n \beta'_n \gamma'_n \\ \delta'_n \epsilon'_n \phi'_n \end{array} \right\} \right\|_{\text{HS}}^2 \leq \exp(-n I_*^{\alpha\beta\gamma\delta\epsilon\phi} / 6 + O(\log n)). \quad (108)$$

where $I_*^{\alpha\beta\gamma\delta\epsilon\phi} > 0$ quantifies the deviation of $(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi)$ from being tetrahedral:

$$I_*^{\alpha\beta\gamma\delta\epsilon\phi} = \min_{\substack{\tilde{\alpha}\tilde{\beta}\tilde{\gamma}\tilde{\delta}\tilde{\epsilon}\tilde{\phi} \\ \text{tetrahedral}}} I_{\tilde{\alpha}\tilde{\beta}\tilde{\gamma}\tilde{\delta}\tilde{\epsilon}\tilde{\phi}}^{\alpha\beta\gamma\delta\epsilon\phi}. \quad (109)$$

Proof. Let dX be the normalized Hilbert-Schmidt measure over $d \times d$ density matrices and let k be a positive integer. Then define an operator Γ_k on $(\mathbb{C}^d)^{\otimes k}$ by

$$\Gamma_k := \int dX X^{\otimes k}. \quad (110)$$

As Γ_k is known to be both S_k and $\text{SU}(d)$ equivariant, by Schur's lemma, Γ_k can be expressed as

$$\Gamma_k = \sum_{\lambda' \vdash_d k} r_{\lambda'} P_{\lambda'} \quad (111)$$

with coefficients $r_{\lambda'}$ that can be computed [ZS01; Wal14] to obtain

$$r_{\lambda'} = \frac{\dim(V_{\lambda'}^d)}{\dim(W_{\lambda'}) \dim(V_{(k)}^{d^2})}. \quad (112)$$

Now let $(\alpha', \beta', \gamma', \delta', \epsilon', \phi')$ be arbitrary Young diagrams with respective sizes $(x, y, x+y, z, x+y+z, y+z)$ where x, y, z are determined by a positive integer n as in Theorem 29. Using Eq. (71), we obtain the formula

$$\left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha' & \beta' & \gamma' \\ \delta' & \epsilon' & \phi' \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_{\text{HS}}^2 = \frac{\text{Tr}(\Pi_{\alpha'\beta'\delta'\epsilon'}^{\phi'} \Pi_{\alpha'\beta'\delta'\epsilon'}^{\gamma'})}{\dim(V_{\epsilon'}^d) \dim(W_{\alpha'}) \dim(W_{\beta'}) \dim(W_{\delta'})} \quad (113)$$

$$= R_{\alpha', \beta', \delta'; \epsilon'} \text{Tr}(\Pi_{\alpha'\beta'\delta'\epsilon'}^{\phi'} (\Gamma_x \otimes \Gamma_y \otimes \Gamma_z) \Pi_{\alpha'\beta'\delta'\epsilon'}^{\gamma'}) \quad (114)$$

where the coefficient $R_{\alpha', \beta', \delta'; \epsilon'}$ is a ratio of dimensions:

$$R_{\alpha', \beta', \delta'; \epsilon'} := \frac{\dim(V_{(x)}^{d^2}) \dim(V_{(y)}^{d^2}) \dim(V_{(z)}^{d^2})}{\dim(V_{\epsilon'}^d) \dim(V_{\alpha'}^d) \dim(V_{\beta'}^d) \dim(V_{\delta'}^d)}. \quad (115)$$

Moreover, by the definition of Γ_k , we have

$$\text{Tr}(\Pi_{\alpha'\beta'\delta'\epsilon'}^{\phi'} (\Gamma_x \otimes \Gamma_y \otimes \Gamma_z) \Pi_{\alpha'\beta'\delta'\epsilon'}^{\gamma'}) \quad (116)$$

$$= \int dX \int dY \int dZ \text{Tr}(\Pi_{\alpha'\beta'\delta'\epsilon'}^{\phi'} (X^{\otimes x} \otimes Y^{\otimes y} \otimes Z^{\otimes z}) \Pi_{\alpha'\beta'\delta'\epsilon'}^{\gamma'}), \quad (117)$$

where the integral is taken over a triple of $d \times d$ density matrices X, Y, Z . For each integrand, define a tetrahedral sextuple $(\tilde{A}, \tilde{B}, \tilde{C}, \tilde{D}, \tilde{E}, \tilde{F})$ as follows

$$\begin{aligned} \tilde{A} &:= |\alpha| X, & \tilde{B} &:= |\beta| Y, & \tilde{C} &:= |\alpha| X + |\beta| Y, \\ \tilde{D} &:= |\delta| Z, & \tilde{E} &:= |\alpha| X + |\beta| Y + |\gamma| Z, & \tilde{F} &:= |\beta| Y + |\delta| Z. \end{aligned} \quad (118)$$

Furthermore, let $(\tilde{\alpha}, \tilde{\beta}, \tilde{\gamma}, \tilde{\delta}, \tilde{\epsilon}, \tilde{\phi})$ be the eigenvalues of $(\tilde{A}, \tilde{B}, \tilde{C}, \tilde{D}, \tilde{E}, \tilde{F})$. In this notation, the integrand above is equal to

$$Q_{\tilde{A}, \tilde{B}, \tilde{C}, \tilde{D}, \tilde{E}, \tilde{F}}^{\alpha' \beta' \gamma' \delta' \epsilon' \phi'} = \text{Tr}(\Pi_{\alpha'\beta'\delta'\epsilon'}^{\phi'} (X^{\otimes x} \otimes Y^{\otimes y} \otimes Z^{\otimes z}) \Pi_{\alpha'\beta'\delta'\epsilon'}^{\gamma'}) \quad (119)$$

Moreover, by Eq. (79) we have

$$\left| Q_{\tilde{A}, \tilde{B}, \tilde{C}, \tilde{D}, \tilde{E}, \tilde{F}}^{\alpha' \beta' \gamma' \delta' \epsilon' \phi'} \right| \leq p(n) \exp(-n I_{\tilde{\alpha} \tilde{\beta} \tilde{\gamma} \tilde{\delta} \tilde{\epsilon} \tilde{\phi}}^{\alpha' \beta' \gamma' \delta' \epsilon' \phi'} / 6). \quad (120)$$

Under the assumption that $(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi)$ are not tetrahedral, we conclude that

$$(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi) \neq (\tilde{\alpha}, \tilde{\beta}, \tilde{\gamma}, \tilde{\delta}, \tilde{\epsilon}, \tilde{\phi}) \quad (121)$$

and therefore $I_{\tilde{\alpha} \tilde{\beta} \tilde{\gamma} \tilde{\delta} \tilde{\epsilon} \tilde{\phi}}^{\alpha \beta \gamma \delta \epsilon \phi} > 0$. **TODO: Figure out how to describe the convergence, is there a triangle inequality for relative entropies? Maybe we need to relax the rate function I to its geometric analogue using Pinsker's inequality, then everything works.** $\square$

4.3 The asymptotics of irrep dimensions

It will be useful for what follows to better understand how the dimension, $\dim(V_{\lambda}^d)$, of the irreducible representation V_{λ}^d of $\text{SL}(d)$ grows as d becomes much larger $|\lambda|$ while $|\lambda|$ itself is much larger than $\ell(\lambda)$. Itzykson and Nauenberg provide the following estimate for $\dim(V_{\lambda}^d)$ [IN66].

lem:in_estimate

Lemma 32. *Let λ be an positive integer partition of length $\ell := \ell(\lambda)$, let $d \geq \ell$ be a positive integer and let $\rho^d := (d-1, d-2, \dots, 2, 1)$ be the Weyl-vector for $\text{SL}(d)$. The following approximation holds when $d \gg |\lambda|^2$ and $\lambda_{\ell} \gg \ell$:*

$$\dim(V_{\lambda}^d) = \dim(V_{\lambda}^{\ell}) \times \prod_{i=1}^{\ell} \frac{\rho_i^{\ell}!}{(\lambda_i + \rho_i^{\ell})!} \times d^{|\lambda|} \times \left(1 + O\left(\frac{|\lambda|^2}{d}\right) \right). \quad (122) \quad \text{\textit{eq:in_estimate}}$$

Proof. Weyl's character formula can be used to derive the following formula for $\dim(V_\lambda^d)$ in terms of the Young diagram λ and the dimension d [IN66]:

$$\dim(V_\lambda^d) = \frac{\Delta(\lambda + \rho^d)}{\Delta(\rho^d)} = \prod_{1 \leq i < j \leq d} \frac{(\lambda_i + \rho_i^d) - (\lambda_j + \rho_j^d)}{\rho_i^d - \rho_j^d} = \prod_{1 \leq i < j \leq d} \frac{(\lambda_i - i) - (\lambda_j - j)}{j - i}, \quad (123)$$

where $\Delta(x) = \prod_{i < j} (x_i - x_j)$ is the Vandermonde determinant. Isolating the terms above which depend on d from those that do not yields

$$\dim(V_\lambda^d) = \dim(V_\lambda^\ell) \times \prod_{i=1}^{\ell} \frac{\rho_i^\ell!}{(\lambda_i + \rho_i^\ell)!} \times \prod_{i=1}^{\ell} \frac{(\lambda_i + \rho_i^d)!}{\rho_i^d!}. \quad \text{\textcolor{blue}{\code{eq:dim_separation_large_d}}} \quad (124)$$

Given positive integers a and b such that $b \gg a^2$, one obtains the following approximation:

$$\begin{aligned} \log \left(\frac{(a+b)!}{b!} \right) &= \log \prod_{j=1}^a (b+j) = \sum_{j=1}^a \log(b+j) \\ &= a \log b + \sum_{j=1}^a \log \left(1 + \frac{j}{b} \right) = a \log b + O \left(\frac{a^2}{b} \right). \end{aligned} \quad (125)$$

The assumption that $d \gg |\lambda|^2$ and $i \leq \ell \ll \lambda_\ell \leq |\lambda|$ also implies $d - i = \rho_i^d \gg \lambda_i^2$. Therefore,

$$\log \left(\frac{(\lambda_i + \rho_i^d)!}{\rho_i^d!} \right) = \lambda_i \log \rho_i^d + O \left(\frac{\lambda_i^2}{\rho_i^d} \right). \quad (126)$$

The assumptions also imply the following simplification

$$\log \left(\frac{(\lambda_i + \rho_i^d)!}{\rho_i^d!} \right) = \lambda_i \log d + O \left(\frac{|\lambda|^2}{d} \right) \quad (127)$$

which, when applied to Eq. (124), proves the claim. $\square$

Using Lemma 32, it can be seen that for fixed λ , $\dim(V_\lambda^d)$ generally grows polynomially in d with leading exponent $|\lambda|$ and leading coefficient depending only on λ . The objective of the following lemma is to characterize the asymptotics of this leading coefficient for large $|\lambda|$ and even large d . TODO: Figure out a elegant way to present these “double asymptotics”, maybe just epsilonifying everything, like $\max\{\ell/|\lambda|, |\lambda|/d\} \leq \epsilon$. \code{lem:double_asymptotics}

Lemma 33. *Let everything be as in Lemma 32. Then*

$$\log \dim(V_\lambda^d) = |\lambda| + |\lambda| \log(d) + s(\lambda) + O(\ell^2 \log |\lambda|) + O \left(\frac{|\lambda|^2}{d} \right) \quad (128)$$

where $s(\lambda)$ is defined by

$$s(\lambda) := - \sum_{i=1}^{\ell(\lambda)} \lambda_i \log \lambda_i. \quad \text{\textcolor{blue}{\code{eq:unnorm_shannon}}} \quad (129)$$

Proof. The proof proceeds by considering the multiplicands in Eq. (122) separately. First, we upper bound the dimension $\dim(V_\lambda^\ell)$; for indices $i < j \leq \ell$, one has $(\lambda_i - i) - (\lambda_j - j) \leq |\lambda| + 1$ as well as $j - i \geq 1$ which implies

$$\dim(V_\lambda^\ell) = \prod_{1 \leq i < j \leq \ell} \frac{(\lambda_i - i) - (\lambda_j - j)}{j - i} \leq (|\lambda| + 1)^{\ell(\ell-1)/2}, \quad \text{\textcolor{blue}{\code{eq:dim_lambda_ell_bound}}} \quad (130)$$

and thus $\log \dim(V_\lambda^\ell) = O(\ell^2 \log |\lambda|)$.

Second, we apply Stirling's approximation [Rob55] to the second term in Eq. (122) under the given assumption that $\lambda_\ell \gg \ell$ (which implies $\rho_i^\ell \ll \lambda_i$),

$$\log \left(\prod_{i=1}^{\ell} \frac{\rho_i^{\ell!}}{(\lambda_i + \rho_i^{\ell!})!} \right) = \sum_{i=1}^{\ell} \log \rho_i^{\ell!} - \sum_{i=1}^{\ell} \log(\lambda_i + \rho_i^{\ell!})!, \quad (131)$$

$$= |\lambda| + \sum_{i=1}^{\ell} \left(\rho_i^{\ell} \log \rho_i^{\ell} - (\lambda_i + \rho_i^{\ell}) \log(\lambda_i + \rho_i^{\ell}) + O(\log \lambda_i) \right), \quad (132)$$

$$= |\lambda| - \sum_{i=1}^{\ell} \lambda_i \log \lambda_i + O(\ell \log |\lambda|), \quad (133)$$

[{eq:unnorm_shannon_term}](#)
(134)

Combining Eq. (130) and Eq. (134) with Lemma 32 proves the claim. $\square$

Remark 34. Note that the quantity $s(\lambda)$ defined in Eq. (129) resembles the Shannon entropy,

$$S(p) = - \sum_{i=1}^{\ell} p_i \log p_i \quad (135)$$

of a probability distribution $p = (p_1, \dots, p_\ell)$. Indeed, $s(\lambda)$ is related to the Shannon entropy of the *normalization* of λ by the formula

$$s(\lambda) = |\lambda| S \left(\frac{\lambda}{|\lambda|} \right) - |\lambda| \log |\lambda|. \quad (136)$$

[{eq:little_s_relation}](#)

TODO: Perhaps a more direct way of relating the asymptotics of $\dim(V_\lambda^d)$ to $\dim(W_\lambda)$ can be found in Harrow's paper [Har23, Lemma 2]:

Lemma 35. *Let λ be a Young diagram with at most d parts. Then*

$$\frac{|\lambda|!}{d^{|\lambda|}} \frac{\dim(V_\lambda^d)}{\dim(W_\lambda)} = \prod_{(i,j) \in \lambda} \left(1 + \frac{j-i}{d} \right) \quad (137)$$

4.4 An entropic inequality for tetrahedral spectra

[thm:ud_recouple_bound](#)

Theorem 36. *Let $(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi) \in \mathbb{Z}_{\text{dec}}^d$ be a sextuple of dominant weights for $\text{GL}(d)$ and let $\left\{ \begin{smallmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{smallmatrix} \right\}$ be the corresponding $\text{GL}(d)$ -recoupling operator. Then*

$$\left\| \left\{ \begin{smallmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{smallmatrix} \right\} \right\|_{HS}^2 \leq \left(c_{\alpha, \phi}^{\epsilon} c_{\beta, \delta}^{\phi} c_{\alpha, \beta}^{\gamma} c_{\gamma, \delta}^{\epsilon} \right)^{\frac{1}{2}} \frac{\dim(V_\gamma) \dim(V_\phi)}{\dim(V_\beta) \dim(V_\epsilon)} \quad (138)$$

Proof. **TODO:** Explain what this all means carefully. Applying both the Cauchy-Schwarz inequality with

respect to the contraction annotated below, and Schur's lemma multiple times yields the following inequality:

$$\begin{aligned}
& \textcircled{\epsilon}^2 C_{\alpha,\beta}^\gamma C_{\alpha,\phi}^\epsilon C_{\beta,\delta}^\phi C_{\gamma,\delta}^\epsilon = \\
& \left[\begin{array}{c} \text{Diagram 1} \\ \text{Diagram 2} \end{array} \right] = \left[\begin{array}{c} \text{Diagram 3} \\ \text{Diagram 4} \end{array} \right] \\
& \leq \left[\begin{array}{c} \text{Diagram 5} \\ \text{Diagram 6} \end{array} \right]^{\frac{1}{2}} = \frac{1}{\textcircled{\beta} \textcircled{\epsilon}} \left[\begin{array}{c} \text{Diagram 7} \\ \text{Diagram 8} \end{array} \right]^{\frac{1}{2}} \\
& = \frac{\textcircled{\epsilon}^2 \textcircled{\gamma} \textcircled{\phi}}{\textcircled{\beta} \textcircled{\epsilon}} \left[\textcircled{\epsilon} C_{\alpha,\phi}^\epsilon C_{\beta,\delta}^\phi C_{\alpha,\beta}^\gamma C_{\gamma,\delta}^\epsilon \right]^{\frac{1}{2}}
\end{aligned} \tag{139}$$

lem:asymptotic_dimension_ratio $\square$

Lemma 37. Let $\gamma, \phi, \beta, \epsilon$ be a quadruple of Young diagrams such that

$$|\gamma| + |\phi| = |\beta| + |\epsilon| \tag{140}$$

{eq:balanced_sizes}

and that $|\epsilon| = \max\{|\gamma|, |\phi|, |\beta|, |\epsilon|\}$. Let $\ell := \max\{\ell(\gamma), \ell(\phi), \ell(\beta), \ell(\epsilon)\}$ and let d be a positive integer such that $d \geq \ell$. Then

$$\log \left(\frac{\dim(V_\gamma^d) \dim(V_\phi^d)}{\dim(V_\beta^d) \dim(V_\epsilon^d)} \right) = I(\gamma, \phi; \beta, \epsilon) + O(\ell^2 \log |\epsilon|) + O \left(\frac{\epsilon^{2 \text{asymptotic_dimension_ratio}}}{d} \right) \tag{141}$$

where $I(\gamma, \phi; \beta, \epsilon)$ is the function

$$I(\gamma, \phi; \beta, \epsilon) := s(\gamma) + s(\phi) - s(\beta) - s(\epsilon). \tag{142}$$

Moreover, $I(k\gamma, k\phi; k\beta, k\epsilon) = kI(\gamma, \phi; \beta, \epsilon)$ for any $k > 0$.

Proof. The proof follows from four applications of Lemma 33. The assumption that the sizes of the Young diagrams are balanced in the sense of Eq. (140) implies that the $\log(d)$ terms appearing in Lemma 33 cancel each other and one obtains Eq. (141).

Four applications of Eq. (136) yields

$$\begin{aligned}
I(\gamma, \phi; \beta, \epsilon) &= s(\gamma) + s(\phi) - s(\beta) - s(\epsilon) \\
&= \{|\gamma| S(\bar{\gamma}) + |\phi| S(\bar{\phi}) - |\beta| S(\bar{\beta}) - |\epsilon| S(\bar{\epsilon})\} + \dots \\
&\quad \dots - \{|\gamma| \log |\gamma| + |\phi| \log |\phi| - |\beta| \log |\beta| - |\epsilon| \log |\epsilon|\}.
\end{aligned} \tag{143}$$

Under scaling $\lambda \mapsto k\lambda$ for any $k > 0$, observe that $\overline{k\lambda} = \bar{\lambda}$ and $|k\lambda| = k|\lambda|$. Therefore the above expression implies

$$I(k\gamma, k\phi; k\beta, k\epsilon) = kI(\gamma, \phi; \beta, \epsilon) + (|\gamma| + |\phi| - |\beta| - |\epsilon|)k \log k. \tag{144}$$

Since Eq. (140) is assumed to hold, the coefficient in front of the $k \log k$ term appearing in Eq. (144) vanishes and therefore $I(k\gamma, k\phi; k\beta, k\epsilon) = kI(\gamma, \phi; \beta, \epsilon)$ as claimed. $\square$

Theorem 38. *Let $(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi)$ be the eigenvalues of Hermitian matrices (A, B, C, D, E, F) satisfying Eq. (1). Then necessarily $|\beta| + |\epsilon| = |\gamma| + |\phi|$ and furthermore*

$$I(\gamma, \phi; \beta, \epsilon) \geq 0. \tag{145}$$

Proof. The proof follows from asymptotics given by Lemma 37 in the limit as $d \rightarrow \infty$, the upper bound provided by Theorem 36, and the lower bound provided by Corollary 30. **TODO: Finish this** $\square$

5 The additive quantum entropy cone

The purpose of this section is to introduce the notion of an “additive” quantum entropy cone which may be viewed as an analogue to the ordinary quantum entropy cone considered by Pippenger [Pip03]. Formally, quantum states ρ_{ABC} and their reduced states (ρ_{AB} , etc.) are replaced by tuples of positive semidefinite operators (X, Y, Z) and their partial sums $(X + Y, \text{etc.})$. Moreover the von Neumann entropy of each reduced state is replaced by an unnormalized entropy of each partial sum. We prove that the set of all such “allocations” of unnormalized entropies of partial sums forms a convex cone, which we term the “additive quantum entropy cone”. Moreover, we prove that all balanced inequalities which are non-negative over the ordinary quantum entropy cone, such as subadditivity and strong subadditivity, are also non-negative over the additive quantum entropy cone.

In Section 5.1 we introduce our notion of an unnormalized entropy function of PSD matrices and delineate its properties. In Section 5.2, we state our main theorem (Theorem 48) which states that the unnormalized entropy function is strongly subadditive. Then, in Section 5.3 we consider the set of possible unnormalized entropies of partial sums and prove it forms a convex cone. In Section 5.4, we relate the additive quantum entropy cone to the ordinary quantum entropy cone and prove that positive and balanced functionals for the ordinary cone are also positive and balanced functionals for the additive cone, thus providing an alternative proof of Theorem 48. In Section 5.5, we explore how these inequalities related to the concavity of von Neumann entropy.

5.1 The shifted unnormalized entropy function

sec:unent

The primary quantity of interest will be a real-valued function of eigenvalues which resembles von Neumann entropy.

Definition 39. Let $\eta : \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be defined by

$$\eta(x) = \begin{cases} -x \log x & x > 0, \\ 0 & x = 0, \end{cases} \quad (146)$$

where $\log$ is always taken to be the natural logarithm.

Remark 40. For ease of notation, we will henceforth adopt the convention that $0 \log 0 := 0$ so that one can write $\eta(x) = -x \log x$ without consideration for the $x = 0$ case explicitly.

Remark 41. Note that η is a continuous function with maximum at $x = e^{-1}$ of value $\eta(e^{-1}) = e^{-1}$. Also, η is strictly positive on the interval $x \in (0, 1)$ and strictly negative for $x \in (1, \infty)$.

Lemma 42. The function $\eta : \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is subadditive meaning for all $x, y \geq 0$,

$$\eta(x + y) \leq \eta(x) + \eta(y), \quad (147)$$

and more generally strongly subadditive meaning for all $x, y, z \geq 0$,

$$\eta(x + y + z) + \eta(y) \leq \eta(x + y) + \eta(y + z). \quad (148)$$

Proof. This claim is a special case ($d = 1$) of a Theorem 20 which does not depend on this result. $\square$

Definition 43. Given $\beta \in \mathbb{R}$, let N_β be the real-valued function on PSD matrices given by

$$N_\beta(X) = \beta + \text{Tr}(\eta(X)) = \beta + \sum_{i=1}^d \eta(\lambda_i(X)), \quad \text{\texttt{\{eq:shifted_unnormalized_entropy\}}} \quad (149)$$

where $\lambda_i(X)$ denotes the i -th eigenvalue of X . The quantity $N_\beta(X)$ will be called the **(β -shifted) unnormalized entropy** of X .

Remark 44. It is worth remarking why N_β is termed the (shifted) unnormalized entropy. Suppose $(\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_d)$ are the eigenvalues of X . When $\beta = 0$, we have the following

$$N_0(X) = - \sum_{i=1}^d \lambda_i \log \lambda_i. \quad (150)$$

We elect to call $N_0(X)$ the *unnormalized* entropy of X because it coincides with the von Neumann entropy when restricted to inputs X where $\text{Tr}(X) = 1$ (i.e., when X is a density matrix):

$$\text{Tr}(X) = 1 \implies N_0(X) = H(X). \quad (151)$$

In general, $N_0(X)$ is related to the von Neumann entropy of the *normalization* of X according to the formula

$$H\left(\frac{X}{\text{Tr}(X)}\right) = N_0\left(\frac{X}{\text{Tr}(X)}\right) = \frac{1}{\text{Tr}(X)} N_0(X) + \log \text{Tr}(X), \quad (152)$$

or equivalently,

$$N_0(X) = \text{Tr}(X) N_0\left(\frac{X}{\text{Tr}(X)}\right) + \eta(\text{Tr}(X)). \quad (153)$$

or equivalently,

$$H\left(\frac{X}{\text{Tr}(X)}\right) = \frac{N_{-\eta(\text{Tr}(X))}(X)}{\text{Tr}(X)}. \quad (154)$$

The term $N_\beta(X)$ is called the β -shifted unnormalized entropy because $N_\beta(X) = \beta + N_0(X)$.

The following proposition lists some basic properties of the function N_β .

Proposition 45. Let $\beta \in \mathbb{R}$, let N_β be as defined by Eq. (149) and let X be a PSD matrix.

- N_β is a spectral function: for all unitary matrices U ,

$$N_\beta(X) = N_\beta(UXU^\dagger). \quad (155)$$

- by subadditivity of η , we have

$$\eta(\text{Tr}(X)) \leq N_0(X) \quad (156)$$

- Let γI_d be the $d \times d$ scalar matrix with $\gamma \geq 0$ along the diagonal. Then

$$N_\beta(\gamma I_d) = \beta + d\eta(\gamma). \quad (157)$$

- Let $\beta' \in \mathbb{R}$ and $X' \geq 0$ a PSD matrix. Then,

$$N_{\beta+\beta'}(X \oplus X') = N_\beta(X) + N_{\beta'}(X'). \quad (158)$$

It is important to note that $N_\beta(X)$ is not a homogeneous function in X meaning in general

$$N_\beta(X) \neq N_\beta(\gamma X). \quad (159)$$

Nevertheless, there is a sense in which it is homogeneous up to a modification to the value of β which depends on the scaling parameter γ .

lem:deformation_homogeneous

Lemma 46. Let $\gamma > 0$ be non-zero and X PSD. Then N_β is deformation-homogeneous in the sense that

{eq:deformation_homogeneous}

$$N_\beta(\gamma X) = \beta + \gamma N_0(X) + \eta(\gamma) \text{Tr}(X) = \gamma N_{\beta - \text{Tr}(X) \log \gamma}(X). \quad (160)$$

As a special case, letting $\beta = \text{Tr}(X) \log \gamma$ produces

$$N_0(X) = \frac{1}{\gamma} N_{\text{Tr}(X) \log \gamma}(\gamma X), \quad (161)$$

and as a further special case, letting $\gamma = \text{Tr}(X)^{-1}$ yields

$$N_0(X) = \text{Tr}(X) N_{\eta(\text{Tr}(X))}\left(\frac{X}{\text{Tr}(X)}\right). \quad (162)$$

Proof. For any $\gamma > 0$ and $X \geq 0$ we have $\gamma X \geq 0$ and $\lambda_i(\gamma X) = \gamma \lambda_i(X)$. Therefore,

$$\begin{aligned}
N_0(\gamma X) &= \sum_{i=1}^d \eta(\lambda_i(\gamma X)) \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^d \eta(\gamma \lambda_i(X)) \\
&= - \sum_{i=1}^d \gamma \lambda_i(X) \log(\gamma \lambda_i(X)) \\
&= -\gamma \sum_{i=1}^d \lambda_i(X) (\log \gamma + \log \lambda_i(X)) \\
&= -(\gamma \log \gamma) \text{Tr}(X) - \gamma \sum_{i=1}^d \lambda_i(X) \log \lambda_i(X) \\
&= \eta(\gamma) \text{Tr}(X) + \gamma N_0(X).
\end{aligned} \tag{163}$$

□

It is also possible to conceptualize the shifts themselves as unnormalized entropies of scalar matrices.

Proposition 47. *Let $\beta \in \mathbb{R}$. Then there exists a sufficiently large integer $d \in \mathbb{N}_{>0}$ and a $\gamma \geq 0$ such that*

$$N_0(\gamma I_d) = \beta. \tag{164}$$

Proof. For any $\gamma \geq 0$ and integer $d \in \mathbb{N}_{>0}$,

$$N_0(\gamma I_d) = -d\gamma \log \gamma. \tag{165}$$

By varying $\gamma \in [0, \infty)$, the image under $\gamma \mapsto N_0(\gamma I_d)$ is $(-\infty, d/e]$. Therefore, if $\beta \leq 0$, then for all $d \in \mathbb{N}_{>0}$, there exists a γ such that $N_0(\gamma I_d) = \beta$. Otherwise, if $\beta > 0$, then let $d = \lceil e\beta \rceil$. This choice for d places β in the range of the map $\gamma \mapsto N_0(\gamma I_d)$. Then there exists a γ such that $\gamma^\gamma = \exp(-\frac{\beta}{e})$ which satisfies Eq. (164). □

5.2 Inequalities for the unnormalized entropy function

thm:unnormalized_entropy_ineq

Theorem 48. *Let $X, Y, Z \geq 0$ be PSD matrices. Then N_0 is both subadditive*

$$N_0(X + Y) \leq N_0(X) + N_0(Y), \tag{166}$$

eq:subadditive_Hbeta

and also strongly subadditive in the sense that

$$N_0(X + Y + Z) + N_0(Y) \leq N_0(X + Y) + N_0(Y + Z). \tag{167}$$

eq:ssa_unnorm_ent

Proof. We begin by noting that subadditivity (Eq. (166)) is a special case of strong subadditivity (Eq. (167)) under the substitution $(X, Y, Z) \mapsto (X, 0, Y)$ because $N_0(0) = 0$. Therefore it suffices to just prove strong subadditivity (Eq. (167)). The strong subadditivity of N_0 holds as an special case of Theorem 21 where the function f is taken to be the function

$$f(x) := -\eta(x) = x \log x. \tag{168}$$

The derivative of $-\eta$ is

$$(-\eta)'(x) = \log x + 1 \tag{169}$$

which is known to be operator monotone [Cha13] on $\mathbb{R}_{>0}$ as required. □

5.3 The additive unnormalized entropy cone

sec:unent_cone

We are now in a position to actually define allocations of unnormalized entropies of partial sums.

Definition 49. Let $\mathbf{X} := (X_1, \dots, X_n)$ be an n -tuple of PSD matrices, and let $\boldsymbol{\beta} := (\beta_1, \dots, \beta_n)$ be an n -tuple of non-negative real numbers in $\mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}^n$. Define the **allocation of unnormalized entropies** of $\mathbf{X}$ shifted by $\boldsymbol{\beta}$ be the element of $\mathbb{R}^{2^n-1}$ given by

$$\alpha_n(\mathbf{X}|\boldsymbol{\beta}) := (N_{\beta_S}(X_S))_{S \subseteq [n] \setminus \emptyset}, \quad (170)$$

where X_S and β_S respectively denote partial sums over the subset S :

$$X_S := \sum_{i \in S} X_i, \quad (171)$$

$$\beta_S := \sum_{i \in S} \beta_i. \quad (172)$$

Example 50. For example, when $n = 3$, the allocation of unnormalized entropies for $\mathbf{X} = (X, Y, Z)$ when $\boldsymbol{\beta} = (0, 0, 0)$ is

$$\alpha_3(X, Y, Z|0, 0, 0) = (N_0(X), N_0(Y), N_0(Z), N_0(Y + Z), N_0(X + Z), N_0(X + Y), N_0(X + Y + Z)). \quad (173)$$

Remark 51. The shifted unnormalized entropy can always be decomposed as $N_{\beta}(X) = \beta + N_0(X)$. Therefore, the allocation $\alpha_n(\mathbf{X}|\boldsymbol{\beta})$ can also be decomposed as

$$\alpha_n(\mathbf{X}|\boldsymbol{\beta}) = \alpha_n(\mathbf{0}|\boldsymbol{\beta}) + \alpha_n(\mathbf{X}|\mathbf{0}). \quad (174)$$

Note that if the eigenvalues of a PSD matrix X are larger than one, then it becomes possible for the unnormalized entropy $N_0(X)$ to become negative. In what follows, it will be desirable to consider allocations of unnormalized entropies which lie inside the positive cone $\mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}^{2^n-1} \subset \mathbb{R}^{2^n}$. To ensure positivity, we place explicit restrictions on the value of the permitted β -shifts.

Definition 52. /ori The collection of allocations of unnormalized entropies of n -tuples of PSD matrices is defined by

$$\mathcal{A}_n := \{\alpha_n(\mathbf{X}|\boldsymbol{\beta}) | \forall i \in [n] : X_i \geq 0, \beta_i \in \mathbb{R}, \forall S \subseteq [n], N_{\beta_S}(X_S) \geq 0\} \subseteq \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}^{2^n}. \quad (175)$$

Our goal will be to prove that the set, $\mathcal{A}_n$, of the set of possible allocations of shifted unnormalized entropies forms a convex cone. To prove that $\mathcal{A}_n$ forms a convex cone, it suffices to show that it is both closed under scaling by positive constants $\gamma > 0$ and closed under addition.

lem:scalable

Lemma 53. Let $\gamma > 0$ and let $\alpha_n(\mathbf{X}|\boldsymbol{\beta}) \in \mathcal{A}_n$. Then,

$$\gamma \alpha_n(\mathbf{X}|\boldsymbol{\beta}) = \alpha_n(\gamma \mathbf{X} | \gamma \boldsymbol{\beta} + \log \gamma \boldsymbol{\tau}(\mathbf{X})) \in \mathcal{A}_n, \quad (176)$$

where $\boldsymbol{\tau}(\mathbf{X}) = (\text{Tr}(X_1), \dots, \text{Tr}(X_n))$. Moreover, as the origin belongs to $\mathcal{A}_n$, the set $\mathcal{A}_n$ is closed under scaling by non-negative $\gamma \geq 0$.

Proof. Let $\gamma \mathbf{X} = (\gamma X_1, \dots, \gamma X_n)$ be the n -tuple obtained from $\mathbf{X}$ by entry-wise multiplication by the same factor γ and likewise $\gamma \boldsymbol{\beta} = (\gamma \beta_1, \dots, \gamma \beta_n)$. If $\gamma = 0$, then the claim holds trivially because the origin belongs to $\mathcal{A}_n$. For $\gamma > 0$, the deformation-homogeneous property of shifted unnormalized entropies (Eq. (160)) implies for any $\boldsymbol{\beta}'$,

$$\alpha_n(\gamma \mathbf{X}|\boldsymbol{\beta}') = \gamma \alpha_n(\mathbf{X}|\boldsymbol{\beta}' - \log \gamma \boldsymbol{\tau}(\mathbf{X})). \quad (177)$$

Letting $\boldsymbol{\beta}' = \boldsymbol{\beta} + \log \gamma \boldsymbol{\tau}(\mathbf{X})$ yields

$$\gamma \alpha_n(\mathbf{X}|\boldsymbol{\beta}) = \alpha_n(\gamma \mathbf{X} | \boldsymbol{\beta} + \log \gamma \boldsymbol{\tau}(\mathbf{X})). \quad (178)$$

The additional claim that $\gamma \alpha_n(\gamma \mathbf{X}|\boldsymbol{\beta}) \in \mathcal{A}_n$ follows because $N_{\gamma \beta_S + \text{Tr}(X_S) \log \gamma}(\gamma X_S) = \gamma N_{\beta_S}(X_S) \geq 0$ where the last inequality follows from positivity of γ and the assumption that $\alpha_n(\mathbf{X}|\boldsymbol{\beta}) \in \mathcal{A}_n$. $\square$

Next we show that $\mathcal{A}_n$ is closed under addition.

lem:additive

Lemma 54. *Let $\mathbf{X} = (X_1, \dots, X_n)$ and $\mathbf{X}' = (X'_1, \dots, X'_n)$ be non-zero n -tuples of PSD matrices and let $\beta, \beta' \in \mathbb{R}^n$. Let $\mathbf{X} \oplus \mathbf{X}'$ be the n -tuple*

$$\mathbf{X} \oplus \mathbf{X}' := (X_1 \oplus X'_1, \dots, X_n \oplus X'_n). \quad (179)$$

Then

$$\alpha_n(\mathbf{X} \oplus \mathbf{X}', \beta + \beta') = \alpha_n(\mathbf{X} | \beta) + \alpha_n(\mathbf{X}' | \beta'). \quad (180)$$

eq:additive_with_shifts

Consequently, the set $\mathcal{A}_{\beta,n}$ is closed under addition.

Proof. First note that N_0 is additive across direct sums,

$$N_0(X \oplus X') = N_0(X) + N_0(X'), \quad (181)$$

and thus for any $\beta, \beta' \in \mathbb{R}$,

$$N_{\beta+\beta'}(X \oplus X') = N_{\beta}(X) + N_{\beta'}(X'). \quad (182)$$

Then, note that direct sums are distributive across sums so that

$$\sum_{i \in S} X_i \oplus X'_i = \left(\sum_{j \in S} X_j \right) \oplus \left(\sum_{k \in S} X'_k \right), \quad (183)$$

which directly implies Eq. (180). The proof that $\mathcal{A}_n$ is closed under addition follows by noting that the positivity condition is maintained under taking direct sums. $\square$

Theorem 55. *The set $\mathcal{A}_n \subseteq \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}^{2^n-1}$ of all possible allocations of (shifted) unnormalized entropies is a convex cone in $\mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}^{2^n-1}$. We refer to $\mathcal{A}_n$ as the **additive quantum entropy cone**.*

Proof. This follows from Lemmas 53 and 54. $\square$

5.4 Connection to the ordinary quantum entropy cone

sec:qec

The purpose of this section is to compare the *additive* quantum entropy cone, $\mathcal{A}_n$, to the (*multiplicative*) quantum entropy cone previously studied by Pippenger [Pip03].

5.4.1 Embedding n PSD matrices into n -partite quantum states

Definition 56. Let n, d be positive integers and consider the complex vector space $(\mathbb{C}^{d+1})^{\otimes n}$. For each $p \in [n]$, let $\{|0\rangle_p, |1\rangle_p, \dots, |d\rangle_p\}$ be a basis for $\mathbb{C}^{d+1}$ (noting that $|i\rangle_p$ need not equal $|i\rangle_q$ for $p \neq q$). For each $k \in \{0, 1, \dots, n\}$, we define the **weight- k subspace**, $W_k \subset (\mathbb{C}^{d+1})^{\otimes n}$, to be the span of those vectors in $(\mathbb{C}^{d+1})^{\otimes n}$ of the form

$$|i_1\rangle_1 \otimes \dots \otimes |i_n\rangle_n \quad (184)$$

such that exactly k elements of the tuple $(i_1, \dots, i_p) \in [d+1]^n$ are non-zero.

Remark 57. For example, the weight zero subspace, W_0 , is one-dimensional and is spanned by the vector

$$|\emptyset\rangle = |0\rangle_1 \otimes \dots \otimes |0\rangle_n. \quad (185)$$

eq:weight_zero

The weight one subspace, W_1 , is dn -dimensional and is spanned by the vectors $\|i_p\rangle$ where

$$\|i_p\rangle = |0\rangle_1 \otimes \dots \otimes |0\rangle_{p-1} \otimes |i\rangle \otimes |0\rangle_{p+1} \otimes \dots \otimes |0\rangle_n. \quad (186)$$

eq:weight_one

and where $i \in [d]$, $p \in [n]$. The weight two subspace, W_2 , is $d^2 \binom{n}{2}$ -dimensional and is spanned by vectors $\|i_p, j_q\rangle$ where

$$\|i_p, j_q\rangle = |0\rangle_1 \otimes \dots \otimes |0\rangle_{p-1} \otimes |i\rangle \otimes |0\rangle_{p+1} \otimes \dots \otimes |0\rangle_{q-1} \otimes |j\rangle_q \otimes |0\rangle_{q+1} \otimes \dots \otimes |0\rangle_n. \quad (187)$$

eq:weight_two

and where $1 \leq p < q \leq d$ and $i, j \in [d]$.

Remark 58. While the notion of a *weight- k* subspace is technically basis dependent, it is only partially basis dependent. In particular, it is invariant under independent local changes of basis which fix the zero-element, $|0\rangle_p$ of each party p . In other words, the weight k -subspace is invariant under the group $G = (U(1) \times U(d))^{\times n}$ where $U(1) \times U(d) \subset U(d+1)$ refers to the subgroup of the unitary group which preserves the subspace spanned by $|0\rangle_p$. In particular, a weight space decomposition of $(\mathbb{C}^{d+1})^{\otimes n}$ depends only on a fixed product vector $|\emptyset\rangle := |\phi\rangle_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes |\phi\rangle_n$.

[defn:spec_embed](#)

Definition 59. Let $\mathbf{X} = (X_1, \dots, X_n)$ be a n -tuple of $d \times d$ PSD operators and let $(\{|i\rangle_p\}_{i=0}^d)_{p \in [n]}$ be an n -tuple of bases for $\mathbb{C}^{d+1}$. Let $\Gamma(\mathbf{X}) = \Gamma(X_1, \dots, X_n)$ be the Hermitian operator on $(\mathbb{C}^{d+1})^{\otimes n}$ which is block-diagonal with respect to the weight decomposition of $(\mathbb{C}^{d+1})^{\otimes n}$ with non-zero entries given by

$$\langle\langle \emptyset | \Gamma(X_1, \dots, X_n) | \emptyset \rangle\rangle = 1 - \sum_{i=1}^n \text{Tr}(X_i), \quad (\text{eq:weight_zero_portion}) \quad (188)$$

and

$$\langle\langle i_p | \Gamma(X_1, \dots, X_n) | j_q \rangle\rangle = \langle i_p | X_p^{\frac{1}{2}} X_q^{\frac{1}{2}} | j \rangle_q. \quad (\text{eq:weight_one_portion}) \quad (189)$$

For example, the coefficients of $\Gamma_{[n]}$ in the weight-two subspace are zero,

$$\langle\langle i_p, i_{p'} | \Gamma(X_1, \dots, X_n) | j_q, j_{q'} \rangle\rangle = 0, \quad (190)$$

as well as all higher weight spaces.

Example 60. Given two PSD $d \times d$ matrices, (X_1, X_2) , the matrix $\Gamma_{[2]} := \Gamma(X_1, X_2)$ has the following coefficients for all $i, j, k, l \in \{1, \dots, d\}$.

$$\langle 00 | \Gamma | 00 \rangle = 1 - \text{Tr}(X_1) - \text{Tr}(X_2), \quad (191)$$

$$\langle i0 | \Gamma | j0 \rangle = \langle i | X_1 | j \rangle, \quad (192)$$

$$\langle 0i | \Gamma | 0j \rangle = \langle i | X_2 | j \rangle, \quad (193)$$

$$\langle i0 | \Gamma | 0j \rangle = \langle i | X_1^{\frac{1}{2}} X_2^{\frac{1}{2}} | j \rangle, \quad (194)$$

$$\langle 0i | \Gamma | j0 \rangle = \langle i | X_2^{\frac{1}{2}} X_1^{\frac{1}{2}} | j \rangle, \quad (195)$$

$$\langle ik | \Gamma | jl \rangle = 0. \quad (196)$$

Example 61. Given three $d \times d$ PSD matrices $X_1, X_2, X_3 \geq 0$, the operator $\Gamma_{[3]} := \Gamma(X_1, X_2, X_3)$ is the $(d+1)^3 \times (d+1)^3$ matrix with non-zero coefficients given for all $i, j \in \{1, \dots, d\}$ by the formulas:

$$\begin{aligned} \langle 000 | \Gamma | 000 \rangle &= 1 - \text{Tr}(X_1 + X_2 + X_3), \\ \langle i00 | \Gamma | j00 \rangle &= \langle i | X_1 | j \rangle, \\ \langle 0i0 | \Gamma | 0j0 \rangle &= \langle i | X_2 | j \rangle, \\ \langle 00i | \Gamma | 00j \rangle &= \langle i | X_3 | j \rangle, \\ \langle i00 | \Gamma | 0j0 \rangle &= \langle i | X_1^{\frac{1}{2}} X_2^{\frac{1}{2}} | j \rangle, \\ \langle 0i0 | \Gamma | 00j \rangle &= \langle i | X_2^{\frac{1}{2}} X_3^{\frac{1}{2}} | j \rangle, \\ \langle i00 | \Gamma | 00j \rangle &= \langle i | X_1^{\frac{1}{2}} X_3^{\frac{1}{2}} | j \rangle, \\ \langle 0i0 | \Gamma | j00 \rangle &= \langle i | X_2^{\frac{1}{2}} X_1^{\frac{1}{2}} | j \rangle, \\ \langle 00i | \Gamma | j00 \rangle &= \langle i | X_3^{\frac{1}{2}} X_1^{\frac{1}{2}} | j \rangle, \\ \langle 00i | \Gamma | 0j0 \rangle &= \langle i | X_3^{\frac{1}{2}} X_2^{\frac{1}{2}} | j \rangle. \end{aligned} \quad (197)$$

[lem:sum_spec_embed](#)

Lemma 62. Let $\Gamma_{[n]} := \Gamma(X_1, \dots, X_n)$ be defined as in Definition 59. Then the eigenvalues of $\Gamma_{[n]}$ are equal to the eigenvalues of the sum,

$$X_{[n]} := \sum_{i=1}^n X_i, \quad (198)$$

plus the additional value of $1 - \text{Tr}(X_{[n]})$:

$$\text{spec}(\Gamma_{[n]}) \simeq \text{spec}(X_{[n]}) \oplus \{1 - \text{Tr}(X_{[n]})\}. \quad (199)$$

Proof. By definition, $\Gamma_{[n]}$ is block diagonal with respect to the weight decomposition. As the weight-zero subspace is one-dimensional and spanned by $\|\emptyset\rangle = |0\rangle \cdots |0\rangle$, we see that $\|\emptyset\rangle$ is an eigenvector of $\Gamma_{[n]}$ with eigenvalue given by $\langle\langle\emptyset|\Gamma_{[n]}|\emptyset\rangle\rangle$ which is given by Eq. (189), i.e.,

$$\Gamma_{[n]} \|\emptyset\rangle = (1 - \text{Tr}(X_{[n]}) \|\emptyset\rangle. \quad (200)$$

For the remaining eigenvalues of $\Gamma_{[n]}$, let $\Phi_{[n]}$ be the operator $\Gamma_{[n]}$ with its weight-zero entry set to zero:

$$\Phi_{[n]} := \Gamma_{[n]} - (1 - \text{Tr}(X_{[n]}) \|\emptyset\rangle \langle\langle\emptyset|. \quad (201)$$

To prove the claim, it therefore suffices to show that the eigenvalues of $\Phi_{[n]}$ are identical to the eigenvalues of the sum $X_{[n]}$ (with multiplicity). Equivalently, it suffices to prove that the characteristic polynomials of $\Phi_{[n]}$ and $X_{[n]}$ have the same coefficients which is implied by proving that for any positive integer ℓ , $\text{Tr}(\Phi_{[n]}^\ell) = \text{Tr}(X_{[n]}^\ell)$. For $\ell = 1$, the proof follows from performing a single sum over the weight-one subspace

$$\text{Tr}(\Phi_{[n]}) = \sum_{p=1}^n \sum_{i=1}^d \langle\langle i_p | \Phi_{[n]} | i_p \rangle\rangle = \sum_{p=1}^n \sum_{i=1}^d \langle i_p | X_p | i_p \rangle = \sum_{p=1}^n \text{Tr}(X_p) = \text{Tr}(X_{[n]}). \quad (202)$$

For $\ell > 1$, the proof follows from an ℓ -fold sum over the weight-one subspace,

$$\text{Tr}(\Phi_{[n]}^\ell) = \sum_{p_1=1}^n \sum_{i_1=1}^d \cdots \sum_{p_\ell=1}^n \sum_{i_\ell=1}^d \langle\langle (i_1)_{p_1} | \Phi_{[n]} | (i_2)_{p_2} \rangle\rangle \cdots \langle\langle (i_\ell)_{p_\ell} | \Phi_{[n]} | (i_1)_{p_1} \rangle\rangle, \quad (203)$$

$$= \sum_{p_1=1}^n \sum_{i_1=1}^d \cdots \sum_{p_\ell=1}^n \sum_{i_\ell=1}^d \langle i_1 |_{p_1} X_{p_1}^{\frac{1}{2}} X_{p_2}^{\frac{1}{2}} | i_2 \rangle_{p_2} \cdots \langle i_\ell |_{p_\ell} X_{p_\ell}^{\frac{1}{2}} X_{p_1}^{\frac{1}{2}} | i_1 \rangle_{p_1}, \quad (204)$$

$$= \sum_{p_1=1}^n \cdots \sum_{p_\ell=1}^n \text{Tr}[X_{p_1}^{\frac{1}{2}} X_{p_2}^{\frac{1}{2}} \cdots X_{p_\ell}^{\frac{1}{2}} X_{p_1}^{\frac{1}{2}}], \quad (205)$$

$$= \sum_{p_1=1}^n \cdots \sum_{p_\ell=1}^n \text{Tr}[X_{p_1} X_{p_2} \cdots X_{p_\ell}], \quad (206)$$

$$= \text{Tr} \left[\left(\sum_{p_1=1}^n X_{p_1} \right) \cdots \left(\sum_{p_\ell=1}^n X_{p_\ell} \right) \right], \quad (207)$$

$$= \text{Tr}(X_{[n]}^\ell). \quad (208)$$

Therefore $X_{[n]}$ and $\Phi_{[n]}$ have the same eigenvalues with multiplicity which proves the claim. $\square$

cor:spec_of_embed

Corollary 63. *Let everything be as in Lemma 62. Then $\text{Tr}(\Gamma_{[n]}) = 1$. If the eigenvalues of the sum $X_{[n]}$ satisfy*

$$\text{Tr}(X_{[n]}) \leq 1, \quad (209)$$

then $\Gamma_{[n]}$ is positive semidefinite, and thus $\Gamma_{[n]}$ is a density matrix. In such cases, the von Neumann entropy of $\Gamma_{[n]}$ is related to unnormalized entropy of $X_{[n]}$ by

$$H(\Gamma_{[n]}) = (1 - \text{Tr}(X_{[n]})) \log(1 - \text{Tr}(X_{[n]})) + N_0(X_{[n]}), \quad (210)$$

$$= h_{\text{bin}}(\text{Tr}(X_{[n]})) + \text{Tr}(X_{[n]}) N_0 \left(\frac{X_{[n]}}{\text{Tr}(X_{[n]})} \right). \quad (211)$$

Moreover, if the eigenvalues of $X_{[n]}$ satisfy the stronger condition

$$\lambda_1(X_{[n]}) + \text{Tr}(X_{[n]}) \leq 1, \quad (212)$$

then the maximum eigenvalue of $\Gamma_{[n]}$ is $1 - \text{Tr}(X_{[n]})$.

Lemma 64. Let $\Gamma_{[n]} := \Gamma(X_1, \dots, X_n)$ be defined as in Definition 59. Let $S \subseteq \{1, \dots, n\}$ be any subset and let $\Gamma_S := \Gamma((X_i)_{i \in S})$ with $\Gamma_\emptyset := 1$. Then the partial trace of $\Gamma_{[n]}$ over $[n] \setminus S$ is equal to Γ_S :

$$\text{Tr}_{[n] \setminus S}(\Gamma_{[n]}) = \Gamma_S. \quad (213)$$

In particular, letting $S = \{p\}$ yields

$$\Gamma_p := \Gamma(X_p) = (1 - \text{Tr}(X_p)) \oplus X_p = \text{Tr}_{[n] \setminus \{p\}}(\Gamma_{[n]}). \quad (214)$$

Proof. To begin, notice that for any n -partite weight-block-diagonal operator X on $(\mathbb{C}^d)^{\otimes n}$, its partial trace over $S \subseteq [n]$, $\text{Tr}_{[n] \setminus S}(X)$, will also be weight-block-diagonal as an $|S|$ -partite operator because the weight-block-off-diagonal entries of $\text{Tr}_{[n] \setminus S}(X)$ are sums of weight-block-off-diagonal entries of X . Therefore, to prove the claim, it suffices to restrict focus to the weight-block-diagonal entries of $\text{Tr}_{[n] \setminus S}(\Gamma_{[n]})$.

Let $\omega : S \rightarrow \{1, \dots, |S|\}$ be the map which assigns to each $p \in S$ its position in S ordered relative to the ordering on $[n]$. Then the coefficients of $\Gamma_{[n]}$ in the weight-one subspace and the coefficients of Γ_S in the weight-one subspace are related for all $p, q \in S$ according to,

$$\langle\langle i_p \| \Gamma_{[n]} \| j_q \rangle\rangle = \langle i | X_p^{\frac{1}{2}} X_q^{\frac{1}{2}} | j \rangle = \langle\langle i_{\omega(p)} \| \Gamma_S \| j_{\omega(q)} \rangle\rangle \quad \{\text{eq:marginal_joint_correspondence}\} \quad (215)$$

Therefore, the coefficients of $\text{Tr}_{[n] \setminus S}[\Gamma_{[n]}]$ in the weight-one block for all $p, q \in S$ and $i, j \in [d]$ are given by

$$\langle\langle i_{\omega(p)} \| \text{Tr}_{[n] \setminus S}[\Gamma_{[n]}] \| j_{\omega(q)} \rangle\rangle = \langle\langle i_p \| \Gamma_{[n]} \| j_q \rangle\rangle = \langle\langle i_{\omega(p)} \| \Gamma_S \| j_{\omega(q)} \rangle\rangle. \quad (216)$$

Moreover, using Eq. (215) again shows that the coefficient of $\text{Tr}_{[n] \setminus S}[\Gamma_{[n]}]$ in the weight-zero block equals

$$\langle\langle \emptyset \| \text{Tr}_{[n] \setminus S}[\Gamma_{[n]}] \| \emptyset \rangle\rangle = \langle\langle \emptyset \| \Gamma_{[n]} \| \emptyset \rangle\rangle + \sum_{p \notin S} \sum_{i=1}^d \langle\langle i_p \| \Gamma_{[n]} \| i_p \rangle\rangle \quad (217)$$

$$= \langle\langle \emptyset \| \Gamma_{[n]} \| \emptyset \rangle\rangle + \sum_{p=1}^n \sum_{i=1}^d \langle\langle i_p \| \Gamma_{[n]} \| i_p \rangle\rangle - \sum_{p \in S} \sum_{i=1}^d \langle\langle i_p \| \Gamma_{[n]} \| i_p \rangle\rangle \quad (218)$$

$$= \text{Tr}(\Gamma_{[n]}) - \sum_{p \in S} \sum_{i=1}^d \langle\langle i_{\omega(p)} \| \Gamma_S \| i_{\omega(p)} \rangle\rangle \quad (219)$$

$$= \text{Tr}(\Gamma_{[n]}) - (\text{Tr}(\Gamma_S) - \langle\langle \emptyset \| \Gamma_S \| \emptyset \rangle\rangle) \quad (220)$$

$$= \langle\langle \emptyset \| \Gamma_S \| \emptyset \rangle\rangle \quad (221)$$

because $\text{Tr}(\Gamma_{[n]}) = \text{Tr}(\Gamma_S) = 1$. Therefore, $\Gamma_S = \text{Tr}_{[n] \setminus S}[\Gamma_{[n]}]$ which proves the claim. $\square$

It is worth emphasizing that the operators, $\Gamma_{[n]} = \Gamma(X_1, \dots, X_n)$, obtained from an n -tuple $(X_1, \dots, X_n)$ according to Definition 59 do not exhaust all n -partite operators. Nevertheless, there is an elegant characterization of those n -partite operators which can be obtained in this way. This characterization generalizes [CSW18, Proposition 11].

Lemma 65. Let $\rho_{[n]}$ be an n -partite density matrix on $(\mathbb{C}^{d+1})^{\otimes n}$ with rank at most $d+1$ such that there exists a product eigenvector, denoted by $\|\emptyset\rangle\rangle = |\phi\rangle_1 \otimes \dots \otimes |\phi\rangle_n$, such that $\rho_{[n]}$ is weight-block-diagonal with respect to $\|\emptyset\rangle\rangle$ and only supported on the weight-zero and weight-one subspaces.

Then there exists an n -tuple of $d \times d$ PSD matrices $(X_1, \dots, X_n)$ such that up to a local unitary change of basis (which fixes $\|\emptyset\rangle\rangle$), we have

$$\rho_{[n]} \simeq \Gamma(X_1, \dots, X_n). \quad (222)$$

Proof. Since $\rho_{[n]}$ is supported only on the weight-zero and weight-one subspaces and is block-diagonal with respect to these subspaces, the eigendecomposition of $\rho_{[n]}$ has the form:

$$\rho_{[n]} = \lambda_1 \|\emptyset\rangle\rangle \langle\langle \emptyset \| + \sum_{k=1}^d \lambda_{k+1} |v_{k+1}\rangle \langle v_{k+1}| \quad (223)$$

where the eigenvector $|v_{k+1}\rangle$ belongs to the weight-one subspace and thus has the form

$$|v_{k+1}\rangle = \sum_{p=1}^d \sum_{i=1}^d V_{p,i,k} |i_p\rangle \quad (224)$$

for some unknown $n \times d \times d$ tensor of coefficients denoted by $V_{p,i,k}$ and where $|i_p\rangle$ is given by Eq. (186) taken with respect to some n -tuple of bases where $|0\rangle_p := |\phi\rangle_p$. Now, for each party p , let M_p be the $d \times d$ matrix defined by

$$(M_p)_{i,k} := \lambda_{k+1}^{\frac{1}{2}} V_{p,i,k}. \quad (225)$$

With this definition, one obtains

$$\langle\langle i_p | \rho_{[n]} | j_q \rangle\rangle = \sum_{k=1}^d \lambda_{k+1} V_{p,i,k} V_{q,j,k}^* = \sum_{k=1}^d (M_p)_{i,k} (M_q)_{j,k}^* = \langle i |_p M_p M_q^\dagger | j \rangle_q \quad (226)$$

Now by a polar decomposition, for each party p , there exists a PSD $d \times d$ matrix X_p and an $d \times d$ unitary U_p such that

$$M_p = U_p X_p^{\frac{1}{2}}, \quad (227)$$

and therefore,

$$\langle\langle i_p | \rho_{[n]} | j_q \rangle\rangle = \langle i |_p U_p X_p^{\frac{1}{2}} X_q^{\frac{1}{2}} U_q^\dagger | j \rangle_q. \quad (228)$$

Letting $|i'_p\rangle = U_p^\dagger |i\rangle_p$ be a modified basis for party p and letting

$$\mathcal{U}_{[n]} := (1 \oplus U_1) \otimes (1 \oplus U_2) \otimes \cdots \otimes (1 \oplus U_n), \quad (229)$$

we observe

$$\langle\langle i_p |' \mathcal{U}_{[n]}^\dagger \rho_{[n]} \mathcal{U}_{[n]} | j_q \rangle\rangle' = \langle\langle i_p | \rho_{[n]} | j_q \rangle\rangle = \langle i |_p U_p X_p^{\frac{1}{2}} X_q^{\frac{1}{2}} U_q^\dagger | j \rangle_q = \langle\langle i_p |' X_p^{\frac{1}{2}} X_q^{\frac{1}{2}} | j_q \rangle\rangle', \quad (230)$$

which implies $\mathcal{U}_{[n]}^\dagger \rho_{[n]} \mathcal{U}_{[n]} = \Gamma(X_1, \dots, X_p)$ as claimed. $\square$

5.4.2 Comparing allocations of entropy

As a direct consequence of Corollary 63 and Lemma 64 we can compare allocations of unnormalized entropies against allocations of von Neumann entropies.

Corollary 66. *Let $\mathbf{X} = (X_1, \dots, X_n)$ be an n -tuple of PSD matrices such that $\text{Tr}(X_{[n]}) \leq 1$ and let $\Gamma(\mathbf{X})$ denote the corresponding n -partite quantum state. Then the allocation $\alpha_n(\mathbf{X}|\mathbf{0})$ of unnormalized entropies of $\mathbf{X}$ is related to the allocation $\mu_n(\Gamma(\mathbf{X}))$ of von Neumann entropies of $\Gamma(\mathbf{X})$ according to the formula*

$$\mu_n(\Gamma(\mathbf{X}))_S = \alpha_n(\mathbf{X}|\mathbf{0})_S - (1 - \text{Tr}(X_S)) \log(1 - \text{Tr}(X_S)) \quad (231)$$

where $S \subseteq [n]$ and where

$$\mu_n(\Gamma(\mathbf{X}))_S = H(\text{Tr}_{[n] \setminus S}(\Gamma(\mathbf{X}))), \quad (232)$$

$$\alpha_n(\mathbf{X}|\mathbf{0})_S = N_0(X_S). \quad (233)$$

thm:almost_subcone

Theorem 67. *Let $\mathbf{X} = (X_1, \dots, X_n)$ be an n -tuple of PSD matrices and let $\Gamma(\mathbf{X})$ denote the n -partite density matrix given by Definition 59. Then for all sufficiently small $\gamma > 0$,*

$$\|\alpha_n(\mathbf{X}|\tau(\mathbf{X}))(1 - \log \gamma) - \gamma^{-1} \mu_n(\Gamma(\gamma \mathbf{X}))\|_\infty \leq \gamma \text{Tr}(X_{[n]})^2 \quad (234)$$

Proof. By Lemma 64, it is known that the von Neumann entropy of the reduced state of $\Gamma(\mathbf{X})$ (whenever $\text{Tr}(X[n]) \leq 1$ so that $\Gamma(\mathbf{X})$ is a density matrix) over $S \subseteq [n]$ is given by

$$H(\Gamma(\mathbf{X})_S) = N_0(X_S) - (1 - \text{Tr}(X_S)) \log(1 - \text{Tr}(X_S)). \quad (235)$$

Then, mapping $\mathbf{X}$ to $\gamma\mathbf{X}$ and multiplying by γ^{-1} yields

$$\gamma^{-1}H(\Gamma(\gamma\mathbf{X})_S) = \gamma^{-1}N_0(\gamma X_S) - \gamma^{-1}(1 - \gamma \text{Tr}(X_S)) \log(1 - \gamma \text{Tr}(X_S)). \quad (236)$$

Define $f(x)$ over $x \in [0, 1]$ as

$$f(x) := 1 + x^{-1}(1 - x) \log(1 - x). \quad (237)$$

with $f(0) = 0$ and $f(1) = 1$ noting that $f(x) \leq x$ holds for all $x \in [0, 1]$. Now take $\gamma \geq 0$ sufficiently small such that $\gamma \text{Tr}(X_S) \in [0, 1]$ holds for all $S \subseteq [n]$ and thus $\Gamma(\gamma\mathbf{X})$ is a well-defined density matrix. Then,

$$\gamma^{-1}H(\Gamma(\gamma\mathbf{X})_S) = \gamma^{-1}N_0(\gamma X_S) + \text{Tr}(X_S) - \text{Tr}(X_S)f(\gamma \text{Tr}(X_S)), \quad (238)$$

Since $\gamma^{-1}N_0(\gamma X_S) + \text{Tr}(X_S) = N_{\text{Tr}(X_S)(1-\log \gamma)}(X_S)$, we conclude that

$$N_{\text{Tr}(X_S)(1-\log \gamma)}(X_S) - \gamma^{-1}H(\Gamma(\gamma\mathbf{X})_S) = \text{Tr}(X_S)f(\gamma \text{Tr}(X_S)) \leq \gamma \text{Tr}(X_S)^2 \quad (239)$$

cor:balanced_ineqs $\square$

Corollary 68. Let $I : \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}^{2^n-1} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a balanced linear functional which is non-negative on the ordinary quantum entropy cone. Then I is also non-negative on the additive quantum entropy cone.

Proof. Let $\mathbf{X} = (X_1, \dots, X_n)$ be an arbitrary n -tuple of PSD matrices. That I is balanced is equivalent to the claim that $I(\alpha_n(\mathbf{X}|\beta))$ is independent of shifting by β , meaning for any $\beta \in \mathbb{R}$ and thus any γ taken from Theorem 67,

$$I(\alpha_n(\mathbf{X}|\tau(\mathbf{X})(1 - \log \gamma))) = I(\alpha_n(\mathbf{X}|\beta)) = I(\alpha_n(\mathbf{X}|\mathbf{0})). \quad (240)$$

That I is linear and positive on the ordinary quantum entropy cone implies

$$I(\gamma^{-1}\mu_n(\Gamma(\gamma\mathbf{X}))) = \gamma^{-1}I(\mu_n(\Gamma(\gamma\mathbf{X}))) \geq 0. \quad (241)$$

Furthermore, by Theorem 67, the value of $I(\alpha_n(\mathbf{X}|\beta))$ is also positive because

$$I(\alpha_n(\mathbf{X}|\beta)) = I(\alpha_n(\mathbf{X}|\tau(\mathbf{X})(1 - \log \gamma))) \quad (242)$$

$$= I(\omega(\gamma, \mathbf{X})) + I(\gamma^{-1}\mu_n(\Gamma(\gamma\mathbf{X}))) \quad (243)$$

$$\geq I(\omega(\gamma, \mathbf{X})), \quad (244)$$

where $\omega(\gamma, \mathbf{X}) \in \mathbb{R}^{2^n-1}$ is the vector given by:

$$\omega := \alpha_n(\mathbf{X}|\tau(\mathbf{X})(1 - \log \gamma)) - \gamma^{-1}\mu_n(\Gamma(\gamma\mathbf{X})). \quad (245)$$

However, $\alpha_n(\mathbf{X}|\beta)$ is independent of γ so we also have

$$I(\alpha_n(\mathbf{X}|\beta)) \geq \lim_{\gamma \rightarrow 0} I(\omega(\gamma, \mathbf{X})) = I(\lim_{\gamma \rightarrow 0} \omega(\gamma, \mathbf{X})). \quad (246)$$

By the proof of Theorem 67, we know the coefficients of $\omega(\gamma, \mathbf{X})$ are non-negative and bounded above by $\gamma \text{Tr}(X[n])^2$. Therefore, $\lim_{\gamma \rightarrow 0} \omega(\gamma, \mathbf{X}) = 0$ and therefore, $I(\alpha_n(\mathbf{X}|\beta)) \geq I(0) = 0$ as claimed. $\square$

Remark 69. Corollary 68 serves as an alternative proof of that unnormalized entropies satisfy strong subadditivity Eq. (167). Specifically, let $S, T \subseteq [n]$ be subsets and consider the functional $I_{S,T} : \mathbb{R}^{2^n-1} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ defined for $v \in \mathbb{R}^{2^n-1}$ by

$$I_{S,T}(v) := v_S + v_T - v_{S \cup T} - v_{S \cap T} \quad (247)$$

where $v_\emptyset := 0$. This functional is balanced and linear. When evaluated on allocations of von Neumann entropies of n -partite quantum states, it corresponds to the conditional mutual information of between subsystems $A = S \setminus T$ and $B = T \setminus S$ given $C = T \cap S$. Therefore $I_{S,T}$ is non-negative on the ordinary quantum entropy cone because of strong subadditivity of von Neumann entropy. Therefore, by Corollary 68, we conclude that $I_{S,T}$ it is also non-negative on the additive quantum entropy cone which is equivalent to Eq. (167).

Remark 70. Corollary 68 demonstrates that all balanced inequalities which are valid for the ordinary quantum entropy cone are valid inequalities for the additive quantum entropy cone. It is currently a major open problem in quantum information theory whether or not there exists (unconstrained) inequalities for the quantum entropy cone which are not implied by strong subadditivity [LW05]. If there exists balanced inequalities for the quantum entropy cone which go beyond strong subadditivity, then Corollary 68 proves such inequalities also hold for the additive quantum entropy cone. For instance, the following inequality, due to Zhang and Yeung [ZY98], holds for the Shannon entropies of classical probability distributions and is balanced:

$$2I_{C,D} \leq I_{A,B} + I_{A,CD} + 3I_{AC,AD} + I_{BC,BD}. \quad \text{\texttt{eq:zhang-yeung}} \quad (248)$$

It is not known whether this inequality holds for the quantum entropy cone also [Wal14]. If the inequality in Eq. (248) does hold for the von Neumann entropies of quantum states, then Corollary 68 would imply the following inequality constraining the unnormalized entropies of a four-tuple $\mathbf{X} = (A, B, C, D)$ of PSD matrices is valid:

$$\begin{aligned} N_0(A) + 2N_0(C) + 2N_0(D) + N_0(A+B) + N_0(B+C+D) + 4N_0(A+B+C+D) \\ \leq 3N_0(A+C) + 3N_0(A+D) + 3N_0(C+D) + N_0(B+C) + N_0(B+D). \end{aligned} \quad \text{\texttt{eq:zhang-yeung-conjecture}} \quad (249)$$

At the moment, it is unknown whether or not Eq. (249) holds for all PSD matrices (A, B, C, D) .

On a related note, it has been shown by Gross and Walter [GW13] (and also reported by Linden et al. [Lin+13]) that the von Neumann entropies of stabilizer quantum states automatically satisfy every balanced information inequality of Shannon entropies (such as the Zhang-Yeung inequality, Eq. (248), above). In [CLW12], Cadney, Linden, and Winter conjecture that *every* balanced inequality which holds for Shannon entropies of joint probability distributions, also holds for the von Neumann entropies of *every* multipartite quantum states. In light of Corollary 68, this extends to the conjecture that every balanced inequality which holds for Shannon entropies of joint probability distributions also holds for the unnormalized entropies of sums of PSD matrices.

5.5 Comparison with concavity of von Neumann entropy

\texttt{sec:unent_concavity}

At this stage it is worth comparing how the inequalities in Theorem 48 compare to known inequalities concerning von Neumann entropy. Suppose ρ_X and ρ_Y are two density matrices and $\lambda \in [0, 1]$ is a convex parameter. Then it is known that the von Neumann entropy satisfies *concavity*:

$$\lambda H(\rho_X) + (1 - \lambda)H(\rho_Y) \leq H(\lambda\rho_X + (1 - \lambda)\rho_Y), \quad (250)$$

but also an associated upper bound:

$$H(\lambda\rho_X + (1 - \lambda)\rho_Y) \leq \lambda H(\rho_X) + (1 - \lambda)H(\rho_Y) + h_{\text{bin}}(\lambda) \quad (251)$$

where $h_{\text{bin}}(\lambda)$ is the binary entropy function:

$$h_{\text{bin}}(\lambda) = -\lambda \log \lambda - (1 - \lambda) \log \lambda. \quad (252)$$

5.5.1 Concavity upper bound

We first show that this upper bound is related to subadditivity of N_0 . If we let $p_X, p_Y \geq 0$ be weights such that

$$\lambda = \frac{p_X}{p_X + p_Y}, \quad 1 - \lambda = \frac{p_Y}{p_X + p_Y}, \quad \text{\texttt{eq:binary_weights}} \quad (253)$$

then the concavity upper bound above can be equivalently written in terms of the unnormalized entropy N_0 as

$$N_0(\sigma_X + \sigma_Y) \leq N_0(\sigma_X) + N_0(\sigma_Y), \quad (254)$$

where

$$\sigma_X := p_X \rho_X, \quad \sigma_Y := p_Y \rho_Y. \quad \text{\texttt{eq:normalization_scheme}} \quad (255)$$

We note that this expression is equivalent to the subadditivity of N_0 (Eq. (166) from Theorem 48). This is because every non-zero PSD matrix σ_X can be equivalently expressed in terms of a positive weight p_X and a density matrix ρ_X according to the formula:

$$(p_X, \rho_X) := \left(\text{Tr}(\sigma_X), \frac{\sigma_X}{\text{Tr}(\sigma_X)} \right). \quad (256)$$

5.5.2 Concavity lower bound

It is also possible to express the concavity of von Neumann entropy as a kind of superadditivity of a different function, namely the function

$$g(\sigma) = \text{Tr}(\sigma) H\left(\frac{\sigma}{\text{Tr}(\sigma)}\right) = N_0(\sigma) - \eta(\text{Tr}(\sigma)), \quad (257)$$

for PSD σ . The non-negativity of $g(\sigma)$ follows because von Neumann entropy is non-negative, or equivalently the non-negativity of $g(\sigma)$ follows from the subadditivity of η : ($N(\sigma) \geq \eta(\text{Tr}(\sigma))$ and thus $g(\sigma) \geq 0$). In this notation, the concavity of von Neumann entropy is equivalent to

$$g(\sigma_X + \sigma_Y) \geq g(\sigma_X) + g(\sigma_Y), \quad (258)$$

because Eq. (255) and Eq. (253) implies

$$\frac{g(\sigma_X + \sigma_Y)}{\text{Tr}(\sigma_X + \sigma_Y)} = H\left(\frac{\sigma_X + \sigma_Y}{\text{Tr}(\sigma_X + \sigma_Y)}\right) = H(\lambda\rho_X + (1-\lambda)\rho_Y), \quad (259)$$

$$\frac{g(\sigma_X)}{\text{Tr}(\sigma_X + \sigma_Y)} = \frac{\text{Tr}(\sigma_X)}{\text{Tr}(\sigma_X + \sigma_Y)} H\left(\frac{\sigma_X}{\text{Tr}(\sigma_X)}\right) = \lambda H(\rho_X), \quad (260)$$

$$\frac{g(\sigma_Y)}{\text{Tr}(\sigma_X + \sigma_Y)} = \frac{\text{Tr}(\sigma_Y)}{\text{Tr}(\sigma_X + \sigma_Y)} H\left(\frac{\sigma_Y}{\text{Tr}(\sigma_Y)}\right) = (1-\lambda)H(\rho_Y). \quad (261)$$

TC: At the moment it is unclear if the function g satisfies a kind of strong superadditivity, i.e.,

$$g(\sigma_X + \sigma_Y) + g(\sigma_Y + \sigma_Z) \stackrel{?}{\leq} g(\sigma_Y) + g(\sigma_X + \sigma_Y + \sigma_Z) \quad (262)$$

or not, but it is probably worth finding out. The strong superadditivity of g is equivalent to the following upper bound:

$$0 \leq N_0(X + Y) + N_0(Y + Z) - N_0(X + Y + Z) - N_0(Y), \quad (263)$$

$$\stackrel{?}{\leq} \eta(\text{Tr}(X + Y)) + \eta(\text{Tr}(Y + Z)) - \eta(\text{Tr}(X + Y + Z)) - \eta(\text{Tr}(Y)). \quad (264)$$

This inequality (or something very close) may or may not hold.

Below are some more calculations which may prove useful. Let $\sigma_{AY_1Y_2Y_3}$ be an 4-party state defined by PSD X_1, X_2, X_3 as follows:

$$\sigma_{AY_1Y_2Y_3} = \frac{1}{\text{Tr}(X_1 + X_2 + X_3)} \left(X_1 \otimes |1\rangle\langle 1| \otimes |0\rangle\langle 0| \otimes |0\rangle\langle 0| + \right. \\ \left. X_2 \otimes |0\rangle\langle 0| \otimes |1\rangle\langle 1| \otimes |0\rangle\langle 0| + \right. \\ \left. X_3 \otimes |0\rangle\langle 0| \otimes |0\rangle\langle 0| \otimes |1\rangle\langle 1| \right). \quad (265)$$

For each subset $S \subseteq [n]$, let $X_S = \sum_{i \in S} X_i$ denote the partial sum. Then

$$\text{Tr}(X_{123})H(\sigma_A) = g(X_{123}) \quad (266)$$

$$\text{Tr}(X_{123})H(\sigma_{Y_1}) = \eta(\text{Tr}(X_1)) + \eta(\text{Tr}(X_{23})) - \eta(\text{Tr}(X_{123})) \quad (267)$$

$$\text{Tr}(X_{123})H(\sigma_{AY_1}) = g(X_1) + g(X_{23}) + \eta(\text{Tr}(X_1)) + \eta(\text{Tr}(X_{23})) - \eta(\text{Tr}(X_{123})) \quad (268)$$

$$\text{Tr}(X_{123})H(\sigma_{AY_1Y_2}) = g(X_1) + g(X_2) + g(X_3) + \eta(\text{Tr}(X_1)) + \eta(\text{Tr}(X_2)) + \eta(\text{Tr}(X_3)) - \eta(\text{Tr}(X_{123})) \quad (269)$$

$$\text{Tr}(X_{123})H(\sigma_{AY_1Y_2Y_3}) = \text{Tr}(X_{123})H(\sigma_{AY_1Y_2}). \quad (270)$$

(i) Subadditivity between A and Y_1 yields

$$H(\sigma_{AY_1}) \leq H(\sigma_A) + H(\sigma_{Y_1}). \quad (271)$$

In terms of X_1, X_2, X_3 , this is equivalent to concavity:

$$g(X_1) + g(X_{23}) \leq g(X_{123}). \quad (272)$$

(ii) Strong subadditivity implies

$$I_{Y_1, Y_3|A} = H(\sigma_{AY_1}) + H(\sigma_{AY_3}) - H(\sigma_A) - H(\sigma_{AY_1Y_3}) \geq 0. \quad (273)$$

In terms of X_1, X_2, X_3 , this is equivalent to

$$\begin{aligned} & [g(X_1) + g(X_{23}) + \eta(\text{Tr}(X_1)) + \eta(\text{Tr}(X_{23})) - \eta(\text{Tr}(X_{123}))] \\ & + [g(X_{12}) + g(X_3) + \eta(\text{Tr}(X_{12})) + \eta(\text{Tr}(X_3)) - \eta(\text{Tr}(X_{123}))] \\ & \geq [g(X_{123})] + [g(X_1) + g(X_2) + g(X_3) + \eta(\text{Tr}(X_1)) + \eta(\text{Tr}(X_2)) + \eta(\text{Tr}(X_3)) - \eta(\text{Tr}(X_{123}))] \end{aligned} \quad (274)$$

which is equivalent to

$$N_0(X_{12}) + N_0(X_{23}) \geq N_0(X_2) + N_0(X_{123}). \quad (275)$$

(iii) Strong subadditivity implies

$$I_{Y_1, A|Y_3} = H(\sigma_{Y_1Y_3}) + H(\sigma_{AY_3}) - H(\sigma_{Y_3}) - H(\sigma_{AY_1Y_3}) \geq 0. \quad (276)$$

In terms of X_1, X_2, X_3 , this is equivalent to

$$\begin{aligned} & [\eta(\text{Tr}(X_1)) + \eta(\text{Tr}(X_2)) + \eta(\text{Tr}(X_3)) - \eta(\text{Tr}(X_{123}))] \\ & + [g(X_{12}) + g(X_3) + \eta(\text{Tr}(X_{12})) + \eta(\text{Tr}(X_3)) - \eta(\text{Tr}(X_{123}))] \\ & \geq [\eta(\text{Tr}(X_{12})) + \eta(\text{Tr}(X_3)) - \eta(\text{Tr}(X_{123}))] \\ & + [g(X_1) + g(X_2) + g(X_3) + \eta(\text{Tr}(X_1)) + \eta(\text{Tr}(X_2)) + \eta(\text{Tr}(X_3)) - \eta(\text{Tr}(X_{123}))] \end{aligned} \quad (277)$$

which is equivalent to concavity again

$$g(X_{12}) \geq g(X_1) + g(X_2) \quad (278)$$

5.6 Entropies of ensembles & coarse-grained ensembles

Let $(X_1, \dots, X_n)$ be an n -tuple of PSD matrices or equivalently, let

$$\mathcal{E} = \{(p_1, \rho_1), \dots, (p_n, \rho_n)\} \quad \text{\texttt{\{eq:n_ensemble_states\}}} \quad (279)$$

be an ensemble of density matrices (where $\rho_i \geq 0$, $p_i \geq 0$, $\text{Tr}(\rho_i) = 1$ and $\sum_i p_i = 1$).

The *Holevo information*, denoted by $\chi(\mathcal{E})$, of such an ensemble is the quantity

$$\chi(\mathcal{E}) := H\left(\sum_{i=1}^n p_i \rho_i\right) - \sum_{i=1}^n p_i H(\rho_i). \quad (280)$$

A straight-forward calculation reveals that $\chi(\mathcal{E})$ is equal to the mutual information of a classical-quantum (CQ) state of the form

$$\Gamma_{CQ} = \sum_{i=1}^n p_i |i\rangle\langle i| \otimes \rho_i \cong \bigoplus_{i=1}^n p_i \rho_i \quad (281)$$

The mutual information between the classical register C supporting the disjoint states $\{|1\rangle\langle 1|, \dots, |n\rangle\langle n|\}$ and the quantum register Q supporting the states $\{\rho_1, \dots, \rho_n\}$ for the state Γ_{CQ} can be shown to be equal to

$$I_{C,Q}(\Gamma_{CQ}) := H(\text{Tr}_Q(\Gamma_{CQ})) + H(\text{Tr}_C(\Gamma_{CQ})) - H(\Gamma_{CQ}) \quad (282)$$

$$= H\left(\sum_{i=1}^n p_i |i\rangle\langle i|\right) + H\left(\sum_{i=1}^n p_i \rho_i\right) - H\left(\sum_{i=1}^n p_i |i\rangle\langle i| \otimes \rho_i\right) \quad (283)$$

$$= \chi(\mathcal{E}). \quad (284)$$

because the von Neumann entropy of a CQ state associated to the ensemble $\mathcal{E}$ satisfies

$$\mu(\mathcal{E}) := H(\Gamma_{CQ}) = H\left(\sum_{i=1}^n p_i |i\rangle\langle i| \otimes \rho_i\right) = H\left(\sum_{i=1}^n p_i |i\rangle\langle i|\right) + \sum_{i=1}^n p_i H(\rho_i). \quad (285)$$

In what follows, we will be interested in how such information can be *distributed* across multiple classical registers. In particular, for an ensemble $\mathcal{E}$ of n states as in Eq. (279), we consider n classical registers $C_1, \dots, C_n$ along with the CQ state

$$\Gamma_{C_1 \dots C_n Q} = \sum_{i=1}^n p_i \Delta_i \otimes \rho_i \quad (286)$$

where Δ_i is an indicator state of the form

$$\Delta_i = |0\rangle\langle 0|^{\otimes i-1} \otimes |1\rangle\langle 1| \otimes |0\rangle\langle 0|^{\otimes n-i}. \quad (287)$$

Now, given a subset $S \subseteq \{1, \dots, n\}$ and subset of classical registers $C_S := \{C_j \mid j \in S\}$, the reduced state on $C_S \cup Q$ is given by

$$\Gamma_{C_S Q} = \text{Tr}_{C_{-S}}(\Gamma_{C_1 \dots C_n Q}) \quad (288)$$

$$= \sum_{i=1}^n p_i \text{Tr}_{C_{-S}}(\Delta_i) \otimes \rho_i \quad (289)$$

$$= \sum_{i \in S} p_i \text{Tr}_{C_{-S}}(\Delta_i) \otimes \rho_i + \sum_{i \notin S} p_i \text{Tr}_{C_{-S}}(\Delta_i) \otimes \rho_i \quad (290)$$

$$= \sum_{i \in S} p_i \Delta'_i \otimes \rho_i + |0\rangle\langle 0|^{\otimes |S|} \otimes \sum_{i \notin S} p_i \rho_i. \quad (291)$$

Note that $\Gamma_{C_S Q}$ is therefore a CQ state for the coarse-grained ensemble $\mathcal{E}_S$ where

$$\mathcal{E}_S := \{(p_j, \rho_j)\}_{j \in S} \cup \{(p_{-S}, \rho_{-S})\}, \quad \text{where} \quad p_{-S} := \sum_{j \notin S} p_j, \quad \rho_{-S} := \frac{1}{p_{-S}} \sum_{j \notin S} p_j \rho_j. \quad (292)$$

Therefore, the von Neumann entropy of the reduced state $\Gamma_{C_S Q}$ is given by

$$\mu(\mathcal{E}_S) = H(\Gamma_{C_S Q}) \quad (293)$$

$$= H\left(\sum_{i \in S} p_i \Delta'_i + p_{-S} |0\rangle\langle 0|^{\otimes |S|}\right) + \sum_{i \in S} p_i H(\rho_i) + p_{-S} H(\rho_{-S}), \quad (294)$$

$$= \sum_{i \in S} \eta(p_i) + \eta(p_{-S}) + \sum_{i \in S} p_i H(\rho_i) + p_{-S} H(\rho_{-S}), \quad (295)$$

$$= \sum_{i \in S} N_{\mathcal{E}}(\{i\}) + N_{\mathcal{E}}(\neg S), \quad (296)$$

where $N_{\mathcal{E}}(S) := \eta(p_S) + p_S H(\rho_S)$. Moreover, the mutual information between C_S and Q is equal to

$$I_{C_S, Q}(\Gamma_{C_S Q}) = H(\text{Tr}_Q(\Gamma_{C_S Q})) + H(\text{Tr}_{C_S}(\Gamma_{C_S Q})) - H(\Gamma_{C_S Q}), \quad (297)$$

$$= \sum_{i \in S} \eta(p_i) + \eta(p_{\neg S}) + H\left(\sum_{i=1}^n p_i \rho_i\right) - \sum_{i \in S} \eta(p_i) - \eta(p_{\neg S}) - \sum_{i \in S} p_i H(\rho_i) - p_{\neg S} H(\rho_{\neg S}), \quad (298)$$

$$= H\left(\sum_{i=1}^n p_i \rho_i\right) - \sum_{i \in S} p_i H(\rho_i) - p_{\neg S} H(\rho_{\neg S}), \quad (299)$$

$$= \chi(\mathcal{E}_S). \quad (300)$$

Theorem 71. Let $\mathcal{E} = \{(p_1, \rho_1), \dots, (p_n, \rho_n)\}$ be an n -ensemble and for each subset $S \subseteq \{1, \dots, n\}$ let $\mathcal{E}_S$ be the coarse-grained ensemble. Then for every pair of subsets $S, T \subseteq \{1, \dots, n\}$,

$$\mu(\mathcal{E}_S) + \mu(\mathcal{E}_T) - \mu(\mathcal{E}_{S \cup T}) - \mu(\mathcal{E}_{S \cap T}) \geq 0. \quad \{\text{eq:}\mu_{\text{SSA}}\} \quad (301)$$

Moreover, one has

$$N_{\mathcal{E}}(S) + N_{\mathcal{E}}(T) - N_{\mathcal{E}}(S \cup T) - N_{\mathcal{E}}(S \cap T) \geq 0. \quad \{\text{eq:}N_{\text{SSA}}\} \quad (302)$$

where $N_{\mathcal{E}}(S) := \eta(p_S) + p_S H(\rho_S)$.

Proof. By strong subadditivity of von Neumann entropy applied to $\Gamma_{C_1 \dots C_n Q}$ we have for every pair of subsets $S, T \subseteq \{1, \dots, n\}$,

$$I_{C_S, C_T | Q}(\Gamma_{C_1 \dots C_n Q}) := H(\Gamma_{C_S Q}) + H(\Gamma_{C_T Q}) - H(\Gamma_{C_{S \cup T} Q}) - H(\Gamma_{C_{S \cap T} Q}) \geq 0, \quad (303)$$

which is equivalent to Eq. (301) because $\mu(\mathcal{E}_S) = H(\Gamma_{C_S Q})$. Now to prove Eq. (302), note that $\mu(\mathcal{E}_S)$ can also be written as

$$\mu(\mathcal{E}_S) = \sum_{i \in S} (\eta(p_i) + p_i H(\rho_i)) + \left(\eta(p_{\neg S}) + \sum_{p \in \neg S} H(\rho_{\neg S}) \right), \quad (304)$$

$$= \sum_{i \in S} N_{\mathcal{E}}(\{i\}) + N_{\mathcal{E}}(\neg S). \quad (305)$$

Which implies for any subsets $S, T \subseteq \{1, \dots, n\}$

$$0 \leq \mu(\mathcal{E}_S) + \mu(\mathcal{E}_T) - \mu(\mathcal{E}_{S \cup T}) - \mu(\mathcal{E}_{S \cap T}) \quad (306)$$

$$= \left(\sum_{i \in S} N_{\mathcal{E}}(\{i\}) + \sum_{i \in T} N_{\mathcal{E}}(\{i\}) - \sum_{i \in S \cup T} N_{\mathcal{E}}(\{i\}) - \sum_{i \in S \cap T} N_{\mathcal{E}}(\{i\}) \right) + \dots \quad (307)$$

$$\dots + (N_{\mathcal{E}}(\neg S) + N_{\mathcal{E}}(\neg T) - N_{\mathcal{E}}(\neg(S \cup T)) - N_{\mathcal{E}}(\neg(S \cap T))), \quad (308)$$

$$= N_{\mathcal{E}}(\neg S) + N_{\mathcal{E}}(\neg T) - N_{\mathcal{E}}(\neg(S \cup T)) - N_{\mathcal{E}}(\neg(S \cap T)), \quad (309)$$

Since the above inequality holds for any subsets S, T , it also holds for $S' = \neg S$ and $T' = \neg T$. Therefore, we conclude Eq. (302) holds also. $\square$

TC : We have, as a corollary of the previous theorem, Corollary 68 itself without needing to employ some sort of limiting argument. Namely, any balanced inequality of von Neumann entropies of subsystems of multipartite quantum states is also a valid inequality of both μ and $N_{\mathcal{E}}$ quantities of subsets of ensembles of PSD matrices. This is already a large improvement on the previous proof of Corollary 68. What remains is to find a similarly elegant treatment of the notion of the additive entropy cone. I suspect it will involve some sort of downscaling of ensemble probabilities followed by an extension by a “marked” element so as to preserve normalization.

Given an n -ensemble $\mathcal{E} = \{(p_1, \rho_1), \dots, (p_n, \rho_n)\}$ of $d \times d$ density matrices, and $\epsilon \in (0, 1)$, we define an ϵ -extended n -ensemble of $d + 1 \times d + 1$ density matrices by

$$\mathcal{E}^{\epsilon} := \{(p_1, (1 - \epsilon) \oplus \epsilon \rho_1), \dots, (p_n, (1 - \epsilon) \oplus \epsilon \rho_n)\}. \quad (310)$$

Then, for any subset $S \subseteq \{1, \dots, n\}$, if ρ_S is the normalized mixture over S for the original ensemble,

$$\rho_S = \frac{\sum_{i \in S} p_i \rho_i}{\sum_{i \in S} p_i}, \quad (311)$$

then the normalized mixture over S for the ϵ -extended ensemble satisfies

$$\rho_S^\epsilon = \frac{\sum_{i \in S} p_i [(1 - \epsilon) \oplus \epsilon \rho_i]}{\sum_{i \in S} p_i} = (1 - \epsilon) \oplus \epsilon \rho_S. \quad (312)$$

The von Neumann entropy of ρ_S is related to the von Neumann entropy of ρ_S by

$$H(\rho_S^\epsilon) = h(\epsilon) + \epsilon H(\rho_S). \quad (313)$$

Moreover, as the weights in the ϵ -extended ensemble are the same as the weights in the original ensemble, we also have

$$N_{\mathcal{E}^\epsilon}(S) = \eta(p_S) + p_S H(\rho_S^\epsilon) = \eta(p_S) + p_S h(\epsilon) + p_S \epsilon H(\rho_S) \quad (314)$$

$$\mu(\mathcal{E}_S) = \sum_{i \in S} N_{\mathcal{E}}(\{i\}) + N_{\mathcal{E}}(\neg S) \quad (315)$$

$$\mu(\mathcal{E}_S^\epsilon) = \sum_{i \in S} N_{\mathcal{E}^\epsilon}(\{i\}) + N_{\mathcal{E}^\epsilon}(\neg S) \quad (316)$$

$$\Gamma_{C_1 \dots C_n Q}^\epsilon = \sum_{i=1}^n p_i \Delta_i^\epsilon \otimes \rho_i \quad (317)$$

$$\Delta_i^\epsilon = (1 - \epsilon) |\omega\rangle\langle\omega|^{\otimes n} + \epsilon \Delta_i. \quad (318)$$

6 Conclusion

A Multinomial distribution inequalities

In this section, we recall a handful of identities and inequalities concerning multinomial coefficients and the multinomial distribution in the context of Sanov's theorem [DZ10, Chapter 2]. Let $q = (q_1, \dots, q_k)$ be a probability distribution such that for all $i \in \{1, \dots, k\}$, nq_i is an integer. Let $M_n(q)$ denote the following multinomial coefficient:

$$M_n(q) := \binom{n}{nq_1, \dots, nq_k} = \frac{n!}{(nq_1)! \dots (nq_k)!}, \quad \text{\texttt{eq:multinomial_coefficient}} \quad (319)$$

which can be bounded (see [DZ10, Lemma 2.1.8]) in terms of $H(q)$ by ,

$$(n+1)^{-k} e^{nH(q)} \leq M_n(q) \leq e^{nH(q)}, \quad \text{\texttt{eq:multinomial_coefficient_bound}} \quad (320)$$

where $H(q) = -\sum_{i=1}^k q_i \log q_i$ is the Shannon entropy of q . Additionally, we have for any probability distribution $p = (p_1, \dots, p_k)$,

$$p_1^{nq_1} \dots p_k^{nq_k} = e^{-n(H(q) + H(q|p))} \quad \text{\texttt{eq:multinomial_probability}} \quad (321)$$

where $H(q|p) = \sum_{i=1}^k q_i \log q_i/p_i$ denotes the Kullback-Leibler divergence or relative entropy of q from p with the convention that $H(q|p) = \infty$ if $q_i > 0$ whenever $p_i = 0$. Note that $H(q|p) = 0$ if and only if $p = q$. Combining Eq. (320) with Eq. (321) places bounds on the multinomial distribution

$$(n+1)^{-k} e^{-nH(q|p)} \leq \binom{n}{nq_1, \dots, nq_k} p_1^{nq_1} \dots p_k^{nq_k} \leq e^{-nH(q|p)} \quad (322)$$

If needed, it is possible to relax these bounds further using Pinsker's inequality for $H(q|p)$ in conjunction with its reverse (which only holds for $H(q|p) < \infty$) [GSS19]:

$$2d_{\text{TV}}^2(p, q) \leq H(q|p) \leq \frac{4}{p_{\min}} d_{\text{TV}}^2(p, q) \quad (323)$$

where

$$d_{\text{TV}}(p, q) = \max_{1 \leq j \leq k} |p_j - q_j| = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{j=1}^k |p_j - q_j| \quad \text{\texttt{eq:pinskera}} \quad (324)$$

is known as the *total variation distance* between p and q . Now for any distribution $p = (p_1, \dots, p_k)$ and any positive integer n , it is possible to find another distribution $p' = (p'_1, \dots, p'_k)$ such that (i) np'_i is an integer for all $i \in \{1, \dots, k\}$, (ii) $H(p'|p) < \infty$ is finite, and (iii) p' approximates p in the sense that for some constant $C \geq 0$,

$$d_{\text{TV}}(p, p') \leq \frac{C}{n}. \quad \text{\texttt{eq:tv_approx}} \quad (325)$$

Concretely, one can choose p' such that

$$np'_j := \text{nint} \left(n \sum_{i=1}^j p_i \right) - \text{nint} \left(n \sum_{i=1}^{j-1} p_i \right) \quad \text{\texttt{eq:nint_approx}} \quad (326)$$

where $\text{nint} : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$ is the function which rounds each real number to the nearest integer (with half integers always rounded up). Using this approximation, we have $|np_j - np'_j| \leq 1$ because each rounding operation in Eq. (326) introduces an error of at most $1/2$ and thus Eq. (325) holds with $C = 1$. In any case, when Eq. (325) holds for some constant $C \geq 0$, Eq. (324) reveals $H(p'|p) \leq \frac{4C}{p_{\min} n^2}$ which yields a useful, albeit crude, lower bound for the multinomial distribution:

$$\binom{n}{np'_1, \dots, np'_k} p_1^{np'_1} \dots p_k^{np'_k} \geq \exp \left(-\frac{4C^2}{p_{\min} n} - k \log(n+1) \right). \quad \text{\texttt{lem:multinomial_dist_lower_bound}} \quad (327)$$

Lemma 72. Let $k \geq 2$ and let $(w_1, \dots, w_k) \in \mathbb{R}_{>0}^k$ have minimum $w_{\min} := \min\{w_1, \dots, w_k\} > 0$ and let n be a positive integer satisfying $n \geq w_{\min}^{-1}$ and define positive integers $(z_1, \dots, z_k) \in \mathbb{N}_{>0}^k$ by the equation

$$z_i := \lceil nw_i \rceil. \quad (328)$$

Let $Z = z_1 + \dots + z_k$ and $W = w_1 + \dots + w_k$ and defined probability distributions $\bar{z}$ and $\bar{w}$ by

$$\bar{z}_i = \frac{z_i}{Z}, \quad \text{and} \quad \bar{w}_i = \frac{w_i}{W}, \quad (329)$$

for all $i \in \{1, \dots, k\}$. Then

$$\frac{Z!}{z_1! \dots z_k!} \frac{w_1^{z_1} \dots w_k^{z_k}}{W^Z} \geq e^{-4(k-1)^2} (nW + k + 1)^{-k} \quad \text{\textcolor{blue}{\code{eq:multinomial_dist_lower_bound}}} \quad (330)$$

Proof. Let $\delta_j := z_j - nw_j$ denote the rounding surplus such that $0 \leq \delta_j < 1$. Note that for $n \gg k$, we have $Z \approx nW$ because

$$nW \leq Z < nW + k. \quad (331)$$

In this regime, we wish to show that $\bar{z}_i \approx \bar{w}_i$.

$$|\bar{z}_i - \bar{w}_i| = \left| \frac{z_i}{Z} - \frac{w_i}{W} \right| = \frac{|Wz_i - Zw_i|}{ZW}. \quad (332)$$

The numerator above can be bounded independently of n by,

$$|Wz_i - Zw_i| \quad (333)$$

$$= |(nw_i + \delta_i)(w_1 + \dots + w_k) - w_i(\delta_1 + nw_1 + \dots + \delta_k + nw_k)|, \quad (334)$$

$$= |\delta_i(w_1 + \dots + \hat{w}_i + \dots + w_k) - w_i(\delta_1 + \dots + \hat{\delta}_i + \dots + \delta_k)|, \quad (335)$$

$$\leq |\delta_i(w_1 + \dots + \hat{w}_i + \dots + w_k)| + |w_i(\delta_1 + \dots + \hat{\delta}_i + \dots + \delta_k)|, \quad (336)$$

$$\leq (w_1 + \dots + \hat{w}_i + \dots + w_k) + (k-1)(w_i), \quad (337)$$

$$\leq (k-1)(w_1 + \dots + w_k), \quad (338)$$

$$= (k-1)W. \quad (339)$$

Consequently,

$$d_{\text{TV}}(\bar{z}, \bar{w}) = \max_{1 \leq i \leq k} |\bar{z}_i - \bar{w}_i| \leq \frac{k-1}{Z} \quad (340)$$

and therefore

$$\frac{Z!}{z_1! \dots z_k!} \frac{w_1^{z_1} \dots w_k^{z_k}}{W^Z} \geq (Z+1)^{-k} \exp(-ZH(\bar{z}|\bar{w})), \quad (341)$$

$$\geq (Z+1)^{-k} \exp \left[-\frac{4ZW}{w_{\min}} \left(\frac{k-1}{Z} \right)^2 \right], \quad (342)$$

$$\geq (nW + k + 1)^{-k} \exp \left[-\frac{4(k-1)^2}{nw_{\min}} \right], \quad (343)$$

$$\geq (nW + k + 1)^{-k} \exp(-4(k-1)^2). \quad (344)$$

□

TODO: Figure out the best lower bound on the multinomial distribution to use here.

[lem:multinomial_dist_lower_bound_alt](#)

Lemma 73. Let everything be as in Lemma 72. Then

$$\frac{Z!}{z_1! \dots z_k!} \frac{w_1^{z_1} \dots w_k^{z_k}}{W^Z} \geq \left(\frac{1}{20} \right)^k \left(\frac{W}{w_1 \dots w_k} \right)^{\frac{1}{2}} \frac{\text{\textcolor{blue}{\code{eq:multinomial_dist_lower_bound_alt}}}}{n^{\frac{3k-1}{2}}} \quad (345)$$

Proof. The proof follows from a version of Stirling's approximation due to Robbins [Rob55] which states

$$n! = \sqrt{2\pi n} n^{n+\frac{1}{2}} e^{-n} e^{r_n}, \quad \text{where} \quad \frac{1}{12n+1} \leq r_n \leq \frac{1}{12n}. \quad (346)$$

Therefore,

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{Z!}{z_1! \cdots z_k!} \frac{w_1^{z_1} \cdots w_k^{z_k}}{W^Z} &= \frac{Z!}{W^Z} \frac{w_1^{z_1}}{z_1!} \cdots \frac{w_k^{z_k}}{z_k!} \\ &= \left(\frac{1}{2\pi}\right)^{\frac{k-1}{2}} \left(\frac{W}{w_1 \cdots w_k}\right)^{\frac{1}{2}} \left(\frac{Z}{W}\right)^{Z+\frac{1}{2}} \left(\frac{w_1}{z_1}\right)^{z_1+\frac{1}{2}} \cdots \left(\frac{w_k}{z_k}\right)^{z_k+\frac{1}{2}} \exp\left(r_Z - \sum_i r_{z_i}\right). \end{aligned} \quad (347)$$

In this setting, we have assumed $nw_i \geq 1$ which implies

$$nw_i \leq z_i < nw_i + 1 \leq 2nw_i, \quad \text{and} \quad nW \leq Z < nW + k < 2nW. \quad (349)$$

Consequently³,

$$\left(\frac{Z}{W}\right)^{Z+\frac{1}{2}} \geq n^{nW+\frac{1}{2}}, \quad \left(\frac{w_i}{z_i}\right)^{z_i+\frac{1}{2}} \geq \left(\frac{w_i}{nw_i+1}\right)^{nw_i+\frac{3}{2}} \geq \frac{2^{-\frac{5}{2}}}{n^{nw_i+\frac{3}{2}}}. \quad (350)$$

and the remainder term satisfies

$$r_Z - \sum_i r_{z_i} \geq \frac{1}{12Z+1} - \sum_i \frac{1}{12z_i} \geq -\frac{k}{12}. \quad (351)$$

Altogether, we have

$$\frac{Z!}{z_1! \cdots z_k!} \frac{w_1^{z_1} \cdots w_k^{z_k}}{W^Z} = \left(\frac{1}{2\pi}\right)^{\frac{k-1}{2}} \left(\frac{W}{w_1 \cdots w_k}\right)^{\frac{1}{2}} \frac{2^{-\frac{5k}{2}}}{n^{\frac{3k-1}{2}}} \exp\left(-\frac{k}{12}\right). \quad (352)$$

Moreover,

$$\left(\frac{1}{2\pi}\right)^{\frac{k-1}{2}} 2^{-\frac{5k}{2}} \exp\left(-\frac{k}{12}\right) \geq \left(\frac{1}{20}\right)^k \quad (353)$$

□

³Here we use the identity that $x \geq 1$ implies $\left(\frac{x}{x+1}\right)^{x+\frac{3}{2}} \geq 2^{-5/2}$

B [Research Notes]

TC: This section contains a number of notes I've collected about some of the paper's I've been researching over the course of this project. It will, of course, be removed for the final draft.

B.1 Horn's problem & generalizations

- Horn's original paper where they conjectured the form of a necessary and sufficient set of inequalities via an inductive scheme for increasing dimension [Hor62]
- An excellent expository overview of the big picture by Knutson [Knu00]
- An excellent introduction to these ideas is the recent masters thesis on various aspects of additive and multiplicative Horn problems in connection to Vinnikov curves and the Lax conjecture due to Hess and supervised by S. Kuhlmann and M. Infusino [Hes20]
- Quantum-info style proof of Littlewood-Richardson coefficient connection due to Christandl [Chr08]
- Coquereaux and Zuber explicitly outline the link between the orbital measures (i.e. the induced distributions in the sense of Klyachko's random walk approach) and the magnitude of the stretched Littlewood-Richardson coefficients [CZ18]. See also the papers [CMZ20; CMZ19; Zub18].
- A recent article by McSwiggen is an excellent introduction to the Harish-Chandra integral [McS21]. The proof of the Harish-Chandra formula provide by McSwiggen using the heat equation methods from Fegan's 1978 paper [Feg78] seems very promising for deriving a connection to the character formula for the norm of the recoupling operator!
- Speyer [Spe05]
- Generalizations of Horn's problem to the product of unitary matrices [AW97; Bel08; BK16]
- Bhatia [Bha01]
- History account offered by Daftuar and Hayden [DH05], and technical review article by Fulton [Ful00].
- Berline, Vergne, and Walter a pedagogical account of the triple role played by Horn's inequalities in characterizing the existence of invariants vectors in tensor products, the eigenvalues of sums of Hermitian matrices, and intersections of Schubert varieties [BVW18]
- Fulton provides a comprehensive treatment of the connection between representation theory of $GL(d)$ and the geometry and (co)homology of the complex Grassmannians [Ful97]
- Prakash Belkale has contributed greatly to the theory surrounding Horn-type problems: for example, in [Bel04], Belkale provides a *geometric* proof of the equivalence between (i) the structure coefficients of the representation theory of $GL(d)$ (i.e. the LR-coefficients $c_{\mu\nu}^{\lambda}$), and (ii) the structure coefficients of the cohomology ring of the Grassmannian $Gr(d, n)$ of d -dimensional subspaces in $\mathbb{C}^d$. This proof is now complementary to the previously known algebraic proofs which rely on knowledge of the algebra of symmetric functions. This geometric approach taken by Belkale, which emphasizes the tangent spaces of the involved Schubert varieties, is later used by Belkale to provide a geometric proof of the saturation conjecture [Bel02].

B.2 Thompson's conjecture

- Original (indirect) proof through the lense of random walks Klyachko [Kly00]
- The proof of Thompson's conjecture in the style of Alekseev, Meinrenken, and Woodward is the "linearization paper" due to [AMW01].
- See also the related article due to Lamb which summarizes the ideas of [AMW01] while also providing more technical background [Lam05]

- Lu and Evens extend the proof technique of [AMW01] to a larger class of Lie groups [LE03]
- Alekseev, Podkopaeva, and Szenes [APS17a]
- Alekseev, Podkopaeva, and Szenes [APS17b]
- Alekseev and Meinrenken [AM07]
- Deforming the symplectic volume by the s parameter Alekseev et al. [Ale+18]
- **TODO:** track down pdfs for the original triple of papers by Thompson and Therianos titled “On the singular values of matrix products” I, II, and III from 1973
- **TODO:** track down pdfs for the original triple of papers by Thompson and Freede titled “On the eigenvalues of sums of Hermitian matrices” III from 1973 (I and II have been found)
- **TODO:** track down a pdf for Thompson’s 1988 “Matrix Spectral Inequalities” referenced by Klyachko
- Thompson and Therianos [TT73] present a number of interesting counter-examples to the question of whether the inequalities pertaining to the spectra of general matrices can be deduced from looking at the spectra of diagonal matrices (both in the additive and multiplicative cases).

B.3 $6j$ symbols

- For a comprehensive reference textbook for the $6j$ coefficients, see the textbook by Varshalovich, Moskalev, and Khersonskii [VMK88], specifically Chapter 9.
- A great summary by Roberts [Rob02]; also the original result for the asymptotics of the $6j$ symbols due to Roberts [Rob99]
- The masters essay/thesis of Backens (**TODO: check if the pdf Matthias sent to me is the final version**) [Bac10]
- The spectral quantum marginal problem and the $6j$ symbol for the symmetric group Christandl, Şahinoğlu, and Walter [CSW18]
- Usage of Wigner’s $6j$ symbol to compute asymptotic error rates for the promise problem of distinguishing between two possible “change points” for a sequence of unknown pure states to transition from one unknown type to another [AH11]
- See also Coquereaux’s later paper which promotes the alternative, albeit equivalent, usage of the integer-valued gon and tet functions in place of the rational-valued theta (triangular) and irrational-valued $6j$ symbols [Coq23]. Most relevant for this project is [Coq23, Section IV D] which discusses the apparent lack of substantial generalization from $SU(2)$ to $SU(N)$ (“*apart from very few special cases (low dimension of irreps and no multiplicity) worked out by physicists at the time of the eightfold way, we are not aware of any published general result*”).
- The recent paper by Alekseev, Morozov, and Sleptsov (different Alekseev!) covers the case of some multiplicity free formulas for the quantum $6j$ symbols for $U_q(\mathfrak{sl}_N)$ [AMS20]
- Keppeler, Plätzer, and Sjødahl recently calculated $SU(d)$ $6j$ symbols with adjoint representations [KPS24] and a bit earlier [Alc+23] calculated $SU(d)$ $6j$ symbols with at least two fundamental representations [Alc+23].
- Representation theoretic proof of the Regge symmetries due to Boalch [Boa07]
- Asymptotics of quantum $6j$ symbols Taylor and Woodward [TW06]
- The integral formula for the square of the $SU(2)$ $6j$ symbol can be performed by an appropriate change of variables [FL03]. See also other papers by Laurent Freidel and collaborators that are relevant [FK00; FNR07; FKL10].

- Alcock-Zeilinger consider the case of $6j$ symbols for $SU(N)$ for wherein two opposing edges are labelled by fundamental irreps of $SU(N)$ so that all vertices are multiplicity one (or zero) [Alc18] [TC: They also freely use the birdtrack notation which I enjoy.](#)
- Only the tetrahedral symmetry of the $U_q(SL(N))$ $6j$ -symbol is known, the counterpart of the Regge symmetry is still unknown, although Morozov and Sleptsov conjectures the generalized Regge symmetry may be related to the eigenvalue conjecture, just as it is in the case when $N = 2$ [MS18].
- The graphical notion, specifically the use of an additional edge for multiplicity spaces can has been used for a long time, as early as [AB68; Mou84].
- The original Ponzano-Regge paper [PR68]
- Gurau derives the Ponzano-Regge asymptotic formula directly using Stirling’s approximation applied to Racah’s single-sum formula [Gur08]
- Bartlett and Nzaganya work with so-called *coherent loop states* or *Bohr-Sommerfeld states* to develop some semiclassical results concerning the inner products between such states (see also the talk on Youtube) [BN23]
- Aquilanti et al. provides an excellent introduction to subject of classical $6j$ symbols, their history, diagrammatics, presentations and asymptotics [Aqu+12]
- Marzuoli and Rasetti connects quantum computing models to the recoupling theory of $SU(2)$ angular momentum and also considers the semiclassical limit [MR05]
- Artamonov derives an explicit formula for the $d = 3$ case [Art23], and later to arbitrary d [Art24].
- There is a series of papers involving Alexey Sleptsov, starting with a computation of quantum $6j$ symbols for generic dimension d but with symmetric representations in terms of certain hypergeometric polynomials [MMS17], then with a discussion of the eigenvalue hypothesis and its potential connection to generalized Regge symmetries [MS18], then with a calculation of all multiplicity free quantum $6j$ symbols for arbitrary dimension [AMS20], and then finally with the discovery of novel “tug-the-hook” symmetries for quantum $6j$ symbols for all d [LS23].

B.4 Minkowski’s theorem and tetrahedron geometry

- Connecting group-valued moment maps to spherical, flat, and hyperbolic tetrahedron via Minkowski’s theorem from the reconstruction of flat tetrahedron Haggard, Han, and Riello. See also the comments in [HHR16, Section 11] on the utility of *quasi-poisson* (controlled failure of the Jacobi identity) manifolds and group-valued moment maps.
- Foundational results concerning the relationships between the edge lengths, face areas, dihedral and solid angles of a tetrahedron by Richardson [Ric02]
- Bianchi, Dona, and Speziale uses Minkowski’s theorem to parametrize convex polyhedra in $\mathbb{R}^3$ with specified face areas and the associated Kapovich-Millson phase space (i.e., the *space of shapes of polyhedra with fixed areas* and then considers its connection to loop quantum gravity via the usual Guillemin-Sternberg quantization commutes with reduction philosophy which associates invariants of the quantization of the unreduced phase space to the reduced phase space [BDS11] (notice the connection with [HHR16]).
- Regarding an algorithmic construction for the polyhedra appearing in Minkowski’s theorem and their complexity, see this post: [constructive-algorithm-for-minkowskis-theorem](#)
- Charles quantization of polygon spaces, tetrahedron and semiclassical limits [Cha10]

B.5 Quantization, Poisson geometry & quantum groups

- A popular textbook on quantum groups with an emphasis on the connection to Poisson manifolds, Lie bialgebras and their quantizations by Chari and Pressley [CP95]
- Course notes on Poisson geometry with an eye toward quantization by Ciccoli and Witkowski [CW06]
- The PhD thesis of Esposito (from the maths department here in Copenhagen) serves as a introduction to the world of Poisson momentum maps and the notion of a “quantum” momentum map as a deformation of the ordinary “classical” momentum map (where deformation is in the sense of deformation quantization) [Esp12].
- Alekseev [Ale97]
- Papers contained results pertaining to the generalization of Duistermaat-Heckman measures for Hamiltonian group actions with group-valued moment maps by Alekseev, Meinrenken, and Woodward [AMW99; AMW00]
- Kirillov and Reshetikhin [KR90]
- Octahedron Recurrence/Rule Robbins and Rumsey Jr [RR86] applied to the “Hive” ring Knutson, Tao, and Woodward [KTW03], and also Henriques and Kamnitzer [HK06]
- Henriques and Kamnitzer [HK05]
- A reference which contains the formula for the quantum dimension of a representation of $U_q(\mathfrak{sl}(d))$ labelled by λ , thanks Rinat! [Ais97]. See also [AM98] which clarifies the relation between various parameters. Apparently, the x, v, s parameters are apparently natural parameters to consider in the context of invariants of knots and links. The substitution mentioned in [AM98] is the following

$$s = e^{h/2}, \quad v = e^{-dh/2} = s^{-d}, \quad x = e^{-h/2d} = s^{-\frac{1}{d}}, \quad q = e^h = s^2.$$

This is consistent with [Res87] in the sense that

$$[k] := \frac{s^{+k} - s^{-k}}{s^{+1} - s^{-1}} = \frac{q^{+k/2} - q^{-k/2}}{q^{+1/2} - q^{-1/2}}. \quad (354)$$

- Reshetikhin develops the diagrammatics of the category of representations of $U_q(\mathfrak{g})$ motivated by connections to the developing theory of polynomial invariants of knots and links [Res87].
- Moak investigates a q -Stirling’s formula for the logarithm of the q -factorial [Moa84].

B.6 Eigenvalue inequalities

- The general subject of multivariate trace inequalities involving exponentials of sums of Hermitian and products of their exponentials is, of course, intimately related. See for instance the paper by Sutter, Berta, and Tomamichel [SBT17].
- Also the article [FT14] by Forrester and Thompson which describes the connection between Thompson’s inequality and hyperbolic geometry quite explicitly.
- Friedland and Gaubert considers submodular functions associated to operator monotones evaluated on different principal submatrices of a single Hermitian matrix [FG13]. While it is not clear to be yet whether or not one can relate partial sums of matrices to principal submatrices, [FG13] references a paper by Bouhtou, Gaubert, and Sagnol [BGS08] which proves the following family of inequalities for all positive semidefinite $A, B, C \geq 0$ (and $p \in [0, 1]$) [BGS08, Lemma 5.3]:

$$\sum_j \lambda_j(A+B)^p + \sum_j \lambda_j(B+C)^p \geq \sum_j \lambda_j(B)^p + \sum_j \lambda_j(A+B+C)^p. \quad (355)$$

- Audenaert, Hiai, and Petz consider a similar form of “strongly subadditive” functions [AHP10]
- For multivariate inequalities based on idempotents of the symmetric group algebra see Huber’s paper [Hub20].
- For spectral inequalities derived using semidefinite programming, see Huber and Wyderka’s paper [HW22].
- Paksoy, Turkmen, and Zhang produce a large family of polynomial inequalities for positive semidefinite $A, B, C \geq 0$ using the notion of a “generalized matrix function” [PTZ14] (see also [HM21; MM65])

B.7 Uncategorized

- Elementary introduction to toy models of three-dimensional quantum space [Bar03]
- Regge and Williams [RW00] a relatively recent review of discrete approaches to gravity. The essential idea, in contrast to the differential geometry of general relativity, is to model curvature discretely instead of continuously. In particular, one can think of a triangulation of the surface of a sphere; the curvature of the sphere is encoded in the triangulation when a configuration of three (or more) triangles meet at a common vertex with sum of interior angles deviating from π . It is in this sense that Regge and Williams refers to these types of models as “piecewise-flat”. Contained is an overview of various attempts to generalize discrete theories of three-dimensional gravity to four dimensions [RW00, Section III].

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